

MOIL (MOIL)

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Call: Jun 2023

MOIL LIMITED

(A Government of India Enterprise)

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CS/NSE -BSE/ 2023-24/ Date : 20.06.2023

To,
The GM (Listing),
National Stock Exchange of India Ltd,
Exchange Plaza, Plot No.C -1, G Block,
Bandra Kurla Complex, Bandra (East),
Mumbai – 400053

To,
Listing Department
BSE Limited
Phiroze Jeejeebhoy Towers
Dalal Street
Mumbai - 400001
Sub: Investors' and Analysts' Meet – 2023 - Transcript.

Dear Sir/Madam,

Further to our letter no. CS/NSE -BSE/2023 -24/64 dated 17th June, 2023 regarding "Investors' and Analysts' Meet – 2023" , it is to inform that the transcript of the said Meet [dated 16.06.2023] has been uploaded on our website as detailed hereunder:

www.moil.nic.in Investor Relation Disclosures under Reg. 46 and 47 of SEBI LODR Regulation, 2015 Analysts / Institutional investor meet 16/06/2023 - Investors and Analysts Meet -2023 (Transcript)

The transcript is enclosed as Annexure -I.

This is for your kind information and record please.

Thanking you,

Yours faithfully,
For MOIL Limited

N. D. Pandey
(Company Secretary & Compliance Officer)

Page 1 of 17

"Investors and Analysts Meet "
June 16, 2023

MANAGEMENT : MR. AJIT KUMAR SAXENA -CHAIRMAN -CUM -MANAGING DIRECTOR
MR. RAKESH TUMANE – DIRECTOR , FINANCE
MR. M.M. ABDULLA – DIRECTOR , PRODUCTION & PLANNING
MR. P.V.V. PATNAIK – DIRECTOR COMMERCIAL
MS. USHA SINGH – DIRECTOR , HUMAN RESOURCES
MR. NEERAJ PANDEY – COMPANY SECRETARY
MR. JAY KALA – DY. GENERAL MANAGER , MARKETING

MODERATOR : MR. PALLAV AGARWAL – ANTIQUE STOCK BROKING

Pallav Agarwal : Good afternoon , ladies and gentlemen, distinguished guests and the valued investors and analysts fraternity. My name is Pallav Agarwal , I am the Vice President for Metals & Mining sector at Antique Stock Broking, and I on behalf of myself, my colleagues, Suman Kumar and the whole of Team Antique extend a very warm welcome to this highly anticipated Investors and Analysts Meet 2023 of Manganese Ore India Limited. I would also like to extend my heartfelt gratitude to all of you for joining us today.

I firmly believe that this Investors Meet would serve as an invaluable platform for all of us to engage in a meaningful dialogue, exchange ideas and help the management address any concerns or queries the investor community has. We obviously understand that your time is very valuable and that we greatly appreciate your presence here. So I am very happy to announce today that we have with us the whole senior management team of MOIL .

Manganese Ore (India) Limited
June 16, 2023

Page 2 of 17

The team I will just introduce them is represented by the Chairman and Managing Director Mr. Ajit Kumar Saxena, the Director of Finance Mr. Rakesh Tuman, Director of Production and Planning Mr. M.M. Abdulla, Director Commercial Mr. P. V.V. Patnaik, Director HR Madam Usha Singh and also we also have the Company Secretary Mr. Neeraj Pandey and Mr. Kala also as well from the company joining us here. So without taking too much of your time I would now request Mr. Ajit Kumar Saxena Sir to give his inaugural address to the audience.

Ajit Kumar Saxena : Good afternoon everyone and welcome to this Analysts and Investors Meet of MOIL . We are really thankful to all of you and our heartfelt gratitude for reposing faith in us and participating in this Analysts and Investors Meet. As a part of proceeding we will be starting with my opening remarks and after that we will have a brief presentation about company's performance, production, Manganese Ore industry and then we will take questions and answers. Most of you are already aware about the company and its performance and Manganese Ore industry. In addition to this I would like to highlight just few of the developments of the company.

As you know MOIL , its history goes back to almost 120 years back to British era. A syndicate called Central Province Prospecting Syndicate was formed and later on in the year 1908 it was converted to a company firm that is CPMO – Central Province s Manganese Ore Company and later in the year 1962 June it was incorporated as MOIL that is Manganese Ore (India) Limited. As we are all aware it was listed on NSA and BSE in the year 2010 December through disinvestment process of Government of India and participated by Government of Maharashtra and Madhya Pradesh. Considering its performance and other parameters MOIL was upgraded to schedule a company C PSE in the year 2014.

If you talk about the operations of the company that is it is working with three verticals. One is ferroalloy plant and another is EMD plant which is Electrolytic Magnesium Dioxide which is the only plant of Electrolytic Magnesium Dioxide in the country and in doing the import substitution the plant fulfils the requirement of dry cells, pharmaceuticals, batteries and chemicals. At present the company has total lease area of around 1,881 hectares. Between 2016 and 2022 the company has bought back of shares four times to the tune of INR2,076 crores. In the year 2017 the company has also issued bonus shares in the ratio of 1 :1. There was also offer for sale by the Government of India in the year 2017. Present shareholding of Government of India in MOIL is 53.35 %, State Government of Maharashtra 5.96%, Madhya Pradesh Government 5.3%. Remaining 35.3% shares are held by public and institutions. As the mines of companies are situated in the state of Maharashtra and Madhya Pradesh and both the states are promoters of the company it really gives strength to the company.

Coming to the manganese ore you know government has set an ambitious target of 300 billion ton by the year 2030 and manganese ore is an important ingredient in making steel though by quantity it is very small just 3% but has a lot of growth opportunity in the years to come. In order to add manganese ore reserves and resources the company is emphasizing on exploration activity and in FY23 we have explored more than 41,000 meters which was highest since then and this year again we still have a target of around 60,000 plus for exploration.

Manganese Ore (India) Limited
June 16, 2023

Page 3 of 17

In order to meet the demand of manganese ore the company has made strategic plans and also taking various developments works in the mines dated of same will be covered in the presentation. In FY23 the company has registered a growth of 6% over the previous year in production and

has registered second highest and you can say the highest production in last 10 years that is 1.3 million ton and we have an ambitious target of double digit growth in the current year. The profit before tax and the total turnover was INR1,419 crores and has recorded profit before tax INR334 crores and profit after tax INR251 crores.

As MOIL has a track record of continuously paying dividend the board of directors have recommended total dividend of INR3.69 per share for the year 2020-23. During the year the company has completed shaft sinking project at Ukwa mine and we are aggressively targeting the projects remaining at Balaghat and Gumgaon. To keep growth momentum on positive side the company is focusing on 5 Es that is Employee, Exploration, Extension of Leases, Expansion Projects and Enhancement of Production. The company is focusing on both brown field and green field projects to enhance the production by increasing the productivity of existing mine and also by exploring the mining opportunities in other states.

Dear friends, MOIL is having skilled manpower and really experienced to work in underground mines. The management of company is very well experienced and you can repose faith on us. With this I would request my colleague to take forward this presentation and therefore we will have, thereafter we will have question and answer session. Thank you.

Jay Kala: Good afternoon to all of you. On behalf of MOIL I welcome investors and analysts for this meet.

I am giving a brief presentation on MOIL like what MOIL is and what is our future plan? It starts from, as we can see in 1962 MOIL formed with 51% capital with Government and State Government of Maharashtra and MP and in 2010 MOIL become a listed company and in 2023 MOIL achieved its highest production of 1.3 million ton which is the highest in last 10 years.

We have an experienced management led by Shri Ajit Kumar Saxena, CMD MOIL. We have four Functional Directors, two Government Directors and three Independent Directors with us. The total resource in India is about 500 million tons and out of which MOIL having a share of 20% that is around 100 million ton of total resources of India. But in this in the same time MOIL contributes about 45% of domestic production. We have three areas of operations. The first one, the core activity of MOIL is mining of Manganese Ore. MOIL having its underground and open cast mine operations and last year we have produced 1.3 million tons. We have a ferroalloy plant at Balaghat mine which having a capacity of 12,000 metric ton per annum. We also have one EMD plant, electrolytic manganese Dioxide plant at our Dongri Buzurg Mine and having a capacity of 1,500 metric ton and it is basically used in dry cell battery, pharmaceutical industry and chemical industry.

MOIL is under administrative control of Ministry of Steel and having its mine at Maharashtra and Madhya Pradesh states. As you can see that we are having a 10 different mines located at Maharashtra and Madhya Pradesh. The total paid up capital of MOIL is around INR203 crores and out of which Government of India having a holding of 53.35%, Government of Maharashtra having a holding of about 6%, Government of Madhya Pradesh having a holding of 5% and rest public and institutions having a holding of about 35%.

Manganese Ore (India) Limited

June 16, 2023

Page 4 of 17

Our major shareholders other than governments are LIC followed by other institutions like UTI, ICICI etc. Despite of extended monsoon, MOIL achieved its highest production of 1.3 million tons which is the best in last 10 years and also we have achieved highest capex of INR245 crores in the last financial year FY23. MOIL is the largest producer of manganese ore in India having a shareholding of about 45%, having all its mining lease renewed. MOIL is a debt free company, adequate and adequate cash reserves to fund

growth projects, excellent growth and real connectivity and we have a skilled workforce. Now we will share about manganese ore industry. Manganese ore industry is basically used in metallurgical and non-metallurgical industry.

In metallurgical industry it is used in the form of Ferromanganese and Silicomanganese and in non-metallurgical industry it is used by dry cell chemical industry and pharmaceutical industry. Manganese is an important raw material for steel industry. About 30 kg of manganese is required for 1 ton of crude steel production. Our national steel policy stipulates that steel capacity is expected to reach 300 million tons by 2030 and same period the requirement of manganese ore is around 11 million tons. The global production of manganese ore is, you can see that last year the world production of manganese ore is around 59 million tons and in last 6 years it is in the range bound of 59 to 64 million tons and out of which India contributes around 4 to 5% of total world's production.

India is a net importer of manganese ore for past many years and last year we have import 4.64 million tons and the same period MOIL produced 1.30 million tons. MOIL is contributing only 17% of manganese ore requirement of the country and we have a strong potential to go from the current levels. MOIL has planned to increase its production to meet the future demand of manganese ore. The demand of manganese ore is increasing year on year. You can see that in the last year, last 12 years it increased by CAGR of 4.5% whereas the production of manganese

ore has not been raised up to that level. So we have a huge potential to increase our production. Our future plan of MOIL, as our CMD said, MOIL having an ambitious growth plan for doubling its production in next three years and tripling in next six to seven years. MOIL is emphasized on higher exploration to add manganese -ore reserves towards this. As you know, exploration being a core activity of any mining industry for a path of increasing its production. So we did 40,000 meters -odd in FY '23 and this year, we have planned for 70,000 -plus meters.

For achieving our future goal, MOIL has signed the MoU with GMDC in the state of Gujarat, with Government of Madhya Pradesh and with Government of Chhattisgarh for exploration of manganese -ore. We also have planned to go in other states as well as for other minerals. Lastly, EC, about Environment Clearance. So EC is very much essential for mining activities and company has been continuously adding to it. You can see that in financial year FY '20, the total EC with MOIL is 1.91 million tons and last year it was 2.27 million tons and this year MOIL has planned for 3.34 million tons to add in MOIL's account. Thank you.

Management: Yes. Thank you, Mr. Jay for the insightful presentation on MOIL. So now we will open the floor for Q&A. So I will just request whoever is asking questions to please introduce themselves and then go ahead with the question. Participants can raise your hand.

Manganese Ore (India) Limited

June 16, 2023

Page 5 of 17

Analyst: Sir, I am Aspi from Mumbai (Bombay). Sir, I would like to know the reason for giving INR0.69 paisa final dividend. Why not INR0.70 paisa? What was the attraction of INR0.69 paisa?

Management: [inaudible 0: 20:34] Yaa, It was basically, we had discussed the formula of the government guideline. As per that the formula, when we worked out the formula, it was based on the total 30% percentage of net profit.

Analyst: So but in spite of increase in production, the value of sales is reduced. So is it the prices of manganese have come down during the year?

Management: It is a cyclical market. So last year if you see that global steel production has come down. And so basically, our product is used in ferroalloy production and ferroalloy production in country almost 45% to 50% is getting exported.

Domestic steel production has shown growth, but global steel production has not shown.

Analyst: Thank you and all the best.

Abhijit Dey: Good afternoon, everyone. This is Abhijit Dey from JHP Securities, sir. I have a few questions and I hope Palla v will give me enough time for asking those. So first of all sir, I was talking to Mr. Patnaik before the meeting started. I just wanted to know in terms of the capacity expansion plans. You mentioned that the sharp shrinking work at Ukwa is completed. But the two major projects, which is basically Balaghat and Gumgaon, what is the timeline for that to get completed now?

Management: During Financial year but in spite that growth of around 20% or more than 20% this year we are targeting 1.6.

Abhijit Dey: Okay. So, I refer to your annual report of last year, where you mentioned January '24 and June '24 as the dates for Balaghat and Gumgaon to come up. Are you sticking to that timeline?

Management: Yes.

Abhijit Dey: Okay. And what would be the capacity expansion post these two projects coming in, sir?

Management: It is not exactly the capacity of shaft which determines how much you can excavate. It is also the EC and development work in the mines. So this year we are planning 1.6 million tons and next year, it will be premature to say, but it will again be a growth of more than 20%.

Abhijit Dey: Okay. And for that, you are including whatever will come out of Balaghat and Gumgaon?

Management: Definitely.

Abhijit Dey: Okay. And so, that was on the capacity. On the Ferroalloy expansion sir, what is the update there?

Management: Ferroalloy expansion, we had a plan. The plan was drawn sometime in 2018. We got the board clearance. Then recently, we have got EC clearance. Now seeing the international market and viability of the project, we will be taking it up.

Manganese Ore (India) Limited

June 16, 2023

Page 6 of 17

Abhijit Dey: Okay. So you have not started much work there?

Management: We have already got EC, we have already got the land. It is only the equipment part we have to work on.

Abhijit Dey: Okay. But approximately, what timeline are you looking at in terms of commissioning the project?

Management: We just have to look at the viability first.

Abhijit Dey: Okay, fine. So on that first, and in terms of the quarterly production, you did close to about 4 lakh tons last quarter, that is March quarter. And this quarter the run rate seems to be higher than that. So without any expansion coming in, when I say expansion meaning, Balaghat and Gumgaon coming in, what kind of levels can you reach basically, on a quarterly basis in terms of production?

Management: As I said, this year we are targeting 1.6 and Q1 is showing that this last quarter, that is Q4 FY '23, which was highest since inception, I think we will be surpassing that in Q1 of FY '24. We expect more than 1.6.

Abhijit Dey: Okay, great. Thank you. And in terms of sir, the other two business divisions which you are in, one is EMD and Ferroalloy, you mentioned – you talked about it. But EMD, is there any plans of expanding capacity because we are a net importer there also?

Management: Yes, we are seriously thinking it because it has become -- it has been giving positive return only for the last few months. And this capacity was installed sometime in 1991. So though it was there, but now the market is picking up and the way it is performing, we are planning it. Very soon maybe. Just look at the viability and then how much the consumption and then we will decide.

Abhijit Dey: Okay. And sir, one important question from today's perspective is about the high priority manganese sulphate market. That is obviously set to grow in the future because of the electric vehicle battery revolution. Any plans regarding that, anything on the drawing board which you can talk about in terms

of setting up capacity for manganese sulphate, basically, going ahead?

Management: So far no, but the input to manganese sulphate plant which is currently it is -- being consumed around 3,000 tons per month. We have a stock for more than 10 months. So I want if somebody is developing that industry, we assure that we will double or even triple the supply from current months. But right now we do not have any plan to produce MnSO₄.

Abhijit Dey: And sir, coming to the commercial part, of course you supply as you rightly said to ferroalloy exporters in this country. A large part of that obviously goes to them and of course the primary and secondary steel manufacturers. So do you have a differential pricing policy between ferroalloy exporters and primary or secondary steel producers, or is it the same for you?

Management: Not so. It is the same.

Abhijit Dey: Okay, right. Thank you.

Manganese Ore (India) Limited

June 16, 2023

Page 7 of 17

Management: Yes, Abhijit, thank you for the questions. Abhijit, do you want to ask a question?

Abhijit: Hi sir, this is Abhijit from Kotak. Sir, my question is like for many years we have been investing. So almost like INR250 crores is the annual run rate of capex. So this year what would be our guidance?

Management: Around INR290 crores, INR300 crores.

Abhijit: So in terms of the capex and the production target of 2.5 million tons, there has been, there apparently looks to be a delay. I have been covering it off late. So why is this delay and how far you are confident that it will be done by FY '25?

Management: About any specific project you are asking or you are asking about...

Abhijit: That the underground mine shifting, that the shaft which you are putting.

Management: There was some issue. There was unexpectedly ingress of water while sinking the shaft. So now we have taken decision and I am sure this financially we will be completing it. And you are seeing the performance of Q1 this year even without having those shafts. We are going to give the best production since inception. That is costing 4 lakh ton. So I don't think anybody should doubt that whether it will happen or not.

Abhijit: As we go underground, do the grades also improve?

Management: Not so. It keeps varying. But not that when you go deeper the grade will be better.

Abhijit: Understood. Thank you. Just last on it, how much will be the cost of production will be increasing when we go underground?

Management: Look, I mean the kind of planning we have by rationalizing and redeploying the manpower and having the production, I expect on manpower account the cost will go down by INR300 to INR400.

Abhijit: And because of the higher electricity technology, any other...

Management: We would be somewhere around INR6,500 or so. But of course, I mean it will depend on many other factors, but it will definitely be reduced by INR300 to INR400 in the current time.

Abhijit: Understood. That's all from my side. Thank you.

Management: Thank you.

Namit Arora: Thank you all for the detailed comments. This is Namit from Indgrowth Capital. Sir, my question is even today there is a very large proportion of imports that the country is dependent on. And

given the pedigree of your organization and the strengths, while you did talk of doubling in two to three years and tripling in sort of five, six, seven years, but your thoughts on what are some of the constraints that you face and what could be done so that the import substitution could

Manganese Ore (India) Limited
June 16, 2023

Page 8 of 17

come down in an accelerated manner? Is there anything else beyond your current efforts that you could do?

Management: Yes. One thing is that we have to make the product available so that people do not plan, because whatever in such kind of process industry, whatever raw material planning

you do, you have to

do for the next six months. So unless we give them confidence that yes, as and when you required, it will be available, perhaps nobody will plan based on our availability. And second thing is there are certain ferroalloy producers which are a little far from our location. So there we are planning some -- a few things to incentivize that they use domestic alloy first.

Namit Arora: Right. And could you also give some color on the modes of transport, etcetera? And are there any logistical improvements happening on modes of transport which might enhance your competitiveness?

Management: We are open to rail as well as road. So it depends which way customer likes it. And of course, inland waterways, still it is not developed. And more so, there is no big river near our location. So rail and road, whatever customer preference we have. We have rail sidings, we have road loading for trailers and all. So no issues on that front.

Namit Arora: Got it. And so final question, in terms of longer term plans about exploration and discovering new, what is the sort of investments that you are undertaking and efforts, technology and manpower, etcetera, and capital commitment so that there could be some findings?

Management: Look, this year, we have done capex nearly to the tune of our profit, profit after tax. So we have a plan from this level to going up to 340, 360 in the coming few years. But if you talk about the money terms, then we have plans to go up to 340, 360 in the next two, three years. But if you talk about the plans overall, I would just like to elaborate that we are going to form a joint venture with the Gujarat Mineral Development Corporation. I hope within this financial year it will be done. So that will be adding at least in first stroke, 2 lakh ton in a year.

We are also exploring certain blocks in district Jhabua and Balaghat and Chhindwara. So that will give us another area to operate. That will I think, that should become operational by next financial year. Of course, it is premature to say, because the ECs and all do take time, but that is one area. Thirdly, we have applied in Chhattisgarh state that we should be given allotted some land so that we can do exploration activity.

And beyond that, there are other few states where we are contacting state government authorities so that we can have manganese mines. And we are also having interest in even other minerals. So if offered and if it is viable, we would definitely be expanding even beyond manganese.

Namit Arora: Got it. Thank you very much for your very detailed responses. Very helpful, sir. Thank you.

Management: Thank you.

Analyst: Sorry, just you know, two more questions, if you don't mind? Just to you know, continue from where he left, on the GMDC joint venture, sir, you said 2 lakh tons per annum can come in. So by which year are you looking for that to happen?

Manganese Ore (India) Limited
June 16, 2023

Page 9 of 17

Management: We are looking this year, but this year, joint venture would be starting. of course, with all clearances and all. So very first year of operation, we are confident. I think My director production can add to this. We are confident that, it will be adding from very first year of operation to around two lakh tons.

Analyst: So you have the got ECs approval and all that, for this joint venture?

Management: No, that is the thing, which will take time. From joint venture formation and then EC clearances and consent to operate and consent to establish, all these things will take time. But the potential I am telling, don't go for the year, but the potential that, the moment you start, as we have seen, there is potential that, in the first 12 months, you can have two lakh tons.

Analyst: And in terms of the manpower cost, you mentioned that, it will come down by INR300 to INR400 per ton. So I am assuming, you will no

t add any manpower after all the staff sinking is

done in Balaghat and Gumgaon. No more requirement of any manpower?

Management: Yes, there are certain requirements because there are certain statutory requirements, which you

have to fulfil. If you are working on certain phase, you need to have two persons or three persons. There is a certain statutory requirement, but otherwise, yes, we are in the process of rationalising and redeploying.

Analyst: Ok. Because obviously after the last wage agreement, your quarterly wage costs have gone up to INR140 crores odd?

Management: That you know better than me. You had earlier, when you had expressed that, with a reason...

Analyst: I was going to ask you whether, this INR140 crores is something which we you stick to, in the coming quarters or that number can also go up post the shaft sinking work is over basically?

Management: I don't think it will go up.

Analyst: Apart from the usual DA increases and all that, I am saying?

Management: I don't think so.

Analyst: Okay, fine. Thank you.

Management: Hi, Pritesh. It is quite reasonable, but unless you excavate, the results which you are telling is up, at the exploration level. But as you excavate, you get because it keeps changing from place to place and level to level.

Analyst: So as of now, we are not sure of the growth?

Management: Mr. Abdulla, if you can?

Management: Actually, the cut of grade is as per Indian bureau of 10% manganese and we have done this and find 9.5 million tonne of ore of ore is already available there. And as you go and mine, then you will have different bands. I think the average, it will be something around 30% or 32% and all.

Manganese Ore (India) Limited

June 16, 2023

Page 10 of 17

Analyst: And our current grade is around 35%, 37%?

Management: Yes.

Management: It varies from mine to mine. We have in 44%, we have 37%, we have 26% also. So it keeps changing.

Management: Yes.

Analyst: Sir, there was one slide put up, wherein we mentioned about ECs, 23, 24, 25. So all of these are in application mode or all of these are?

Management: There are different stages. Like once, we have given TAR, we have done first stage presentation. It has different stages.

Analyst: So for our understanding, this is yet to be approved, right?

Management: Not exactly. If you are thinking of linking it, with our plan, I can assure you, at 2-2.5 in the year 2025-2026, it will not affect us. So it is quite well in time, we have planned it.

Analyst: The fact that, you mentioned that, we are intentioned to double the production, so for that, full EC is received or still pending?

Management: It is still in process.

Analyst: How much is that in process?

Management: That is, somebody would you like to share?

Management: In different mines, we are having already existing ECs and we are expanding them. For example, at Chikla, we are having for 1.8 and we are going for 4 lakh metric tons. And similarly, we are going for other mines also. And by the time, we get the production capacity, the ECs will be in place.

Management: And if you look at the presentation, the particular slide, it was showing 3.37 for the current year.

Analyst: 2.27, I think?

Management: 2.27, '22 - '23, 3.34 '23 - '24. So it is 3.34 already there.

Analyst: It is already there.

Management: And beyond that, because it is the capacity and then, we are going to that level, then getting the ROM and then separating the waste. So it is not that mathematical that, you dig out and then take certain percentage of it. But this '24, '25, there is no issue. And it is a continuous process. It is not that, you take it once and then stop it. Like in certain mines we have taken when and how, once we have got it and we increase our production, once it comes to that level, say a few months, then again, we will reapp

ly for manganese ignite. So it is a continuous process.

Manganese Ore (India) Limited

June 16, 2023

Page 11 of 17

Analyst: Sir, is it possible to share, what kind of –this is just for us to be able to monitor – what kind of mine-wise production that, we intend to kind of produce for the next three years?

Management: You want right now?

Analyst: Is it that the open-cast mines are going to contribute more? Is it that the underground mines are

going to contribute more? How is the split?

Management: It depends. Like if you take – generally, if you take one mine, so if you have some iron ore, in the open -cast, you do the open -cast mining for a few years, then you go underground. It is – most of the manganese mining goes like that. So it all depends. Suppose we start – the moment, we start Gujarat, we will have some – for a few years, we will have open -cast mining. Then again, it will go underground. Many of the underground mines, which we have today, they were open cast a few decades back. So it is – what kind of a seam, we get in the Mother Earth, that will decide.

Analyst: Okay. Sir, as of now, the landed price versus what we offer, what is the difference and what has been the difference historically?

Management: You are comparing with?

Analyst: The landed versus what?

Management: You are comparing with import prices. Import prices depend on a lot of many factors. What kind of consumption and availability and demand is there across the globe. So if you talk about the cost, I can say, we are competitive with any of the international producers.

Analyst: So including the manpower cost, our cost of operation is INR6,500, sir.

Management: INR6,500. Right now, this year, it was INR6,900 some odd, and we expect to go down by another INR300 to INR400. So it will be around INR6,500.

Analyst: Okay. Just to kind of refresh about the pricing aspect, our price offering for the average grade is how much?

Management: That keeps changing.

Analyst: As of today?

Management: We have a pricing mechanism, so whatever is decided based on many factors. As of today, I think the price is – There are so many grades, we can give you. It is on public tone. We can give you the prices.

Analyst: All right, sir.

Analyst: Sir, Just now you said price mechanism. I just wanted to know, because MOIL is almost in a monopolistic position, what is the market share in the...

Manganese Ore (India) Limited

June 16, 2023

Page 12 of 17

Management: We are not in a monopolistic position. We are producing only 50% of the, what the country is producing.

Analyst: Okay.

Management: Maybe they are some big players, some small players, but there are players. We are producing around, say, 1.3 this year, and total production was 2.82.

Analyst: And in this pricing mechanism, whether the government has any say or it is purely a market process?

Management: We are independent.

Kirtan Mehta: Hello. This is Kirtan Mehta from BOB Capital Markets. Just to take the pricing mechanism forward, is our pricing dependent on a sort of a discount or premium to the international pricing, or does it run quite independent of the way, you say it?

Management: It definitely has one of the factors, but it is not the only factor.

Kirtan Mehta: And what would be typical range versus the landed price at a particular location versus our price? So how do we really look at the – what is the mechanism that you follow?

Management: We follow, on the inventory level, inventory level at our side, inventory level at our user side, international prices, and what is the level of inventory at different ports, so a lot of many factors.

Kirtan Mehta: Right. One more question was about the – we are undertaking a lot of exploration activity now. I just wanted to understand, sort of a typical timeline in carrying out the exploration

n, assessing

the viability of a block. What are the processes involved, and what is the timeline for sort of?

Management: It is basically an effort. This is the first step. Unless you do it, you do not know, what you are going to get. But if you want to know the detail, my director of production and planning can explain you in detail.

Management: Actually, that will depend upon the area of the manganese block, which you are exploring and the depth of ore body that is available and the thickness of that, and what is the probability of getting the ore. So many factors are there for doing the exploration and going for that. If the block is small, you can establish it within one year to one and a half years. If the block is big, then it will take time.

Kirtan Mehta: For the tripling of the production within five years to six years that we are targeting, do we have the reserves already established, or we are looking at it, to come from our exploratory efforts?

Management: Yes, the reserves are already available for this us. Certain resources are the ones which we will convert it into the reserves in the span of two years to three years. Absolutely, there is no problem with the resources.

Management: As you have seen, there are 500 million tonnes reserves and resources in the country and 100 million tonnes reserves and resources are with us
Manganese Ore (India) Limited
June 16, 2023

Page 13 of 17

Kirtan Mehta: Thank you.

Siddhant Dand: Hello, Siddhant Dand I am from a Family Office. So my question was, because we have a strong balance sheet, so why are we going into a JV and not directly going in the Gujarat mine? First question here is...

Management: It all depends on the other person. It is just not our wish. Whether the state gives us the mine based on Section 17 or they want to go for a joint venture.

Siddhant Dand: Okay, my second question is...

Management: Because mining is a state subject.

Siddhant Dand: Fair enough. My second question would be, what is the customer concentration in terms of supplying?

Management: We can say that, we have three clusters. One is Durgapur, another is Chhattisgarh and another is Vizag.

Siddhant Dand: But in terms of customer, like Steel Authority or Jindal or Tata?

Management: It is yes, as SAIL is our customers. Even, Jindal is also our customer. Jindal -Shadeed (Oman) , they have also shown interest, so it keeps changing.

Siddhant Dand: What is the concentration of the top customers?

Management: Concentration of top customers is basically this ferroalloy produces in Chhattisgarh and Vizag.

Siddhant Dand: Okay. Yes, how much?

Management: Top five, first is, we can say SAIL and then Hira Alloys and then Bharat.

Siddhant Dand: So what percentage of...

Management: It is not fixed. It keeps changing. Because it depends on their inventory, their blend and what kind of ferroalloy they have planned to produce. It is volatile.

Rahul Jain: Yes, so this is Rahul Jain here from Systematix. So firstly on production, sir, in last ten years, we have hardly grown from one million to now 1.3 levels. So what gives you that confidence that we can really triple in next five years?

Management: Just look at the performance of this quarter. We have done nothing but you can say it is almost 20% plus we are planning this year.

Rahul Jain: And plus you are saying that 100 million ton reserves you have been carrying for a long time. So what suddenly do you think that and how serious is this attempt to actually...

Manganese Ore (India) Limited

June 16, 2023

Page 14 of 17

Management: I mean, results are speaking. You just look at this quarter. I have not spoken. Somebody from the U.S. said that 4 lakh ton is... I mean, if we expect around 4.2 to 4.3 lakh, this quarter...

Rahul Jain: So you are saying it is not a splash in the pan, it is going to be a

big...

Management: We have potential. We have identified what is to be done. We have set plans what to be done on the EC front, what is to be done on project front. So that is why we are confident.

Rahul Jain: And so on your staff cost, so it is just growing very disproportionately, right? The production hardly grew 30%. Staff cost has doubled. So how do you see the staff cost evolving over the next five years period?

Management: Last year we had a wage revision of employees which is done every 10 years. So that is why it is appearing as a major spurt in it.

Rahul Jain: So how should we see it growing when your production say doubles or triples? Will it grow in the similar fashion or will it be more linear?

Management: Not so. Not in that proportion. Definitely not.

Rahul Jain: So in that sense we can see higher margins, you know, translate obviously because fixed cost will be...

Management: As we have said that we are planning a good amount of capex. So that is what we are – though it is very difficult in manganese ore mining, but we are trying to do whatever possible, that mechanization and automation. So that will help us in saving manpower cost.

Rahul Jain: Now coming to the end of production, so you have concrete plans to double it and to tripling it is going to be next stage of planning, is that right?

Management: Yes. This will – it is not that you can say that it is just switch on and switch off. But we are seeing very clearly that 1.6 million tonnes and 2 and then going to 2.4, 2.5 and so on. And that is what the mandate is. If we are going to produce 300 billion tons of steel, we have to.

Rahul Jain: That's right. And sir, in the initial comments you also mentioned that you are looking at other minerals that you might do. Is there any thing concrete on the cards yet or is it just right now in planning stages?

Management: It is at planning stage. And we have to see what kind of mineral. Because mining activity is a time -- it takes six to seven years to start from concept to production. But we are open. Whenever we get the potential and we see that particular element has potential, we will go.

Rahul Jain: And this year you said INR300 crores capex, right? Is there any kind of break -up on what elements are this money being spent?

Management: We will come back to you.

Rahul Jain: Yes, sure. Thanks.

Manganese Ore (India) Limited

June 16, 2023

Page 15 of 17

Management: Any other questions from the audience?

Piyush Shah : This is Piyush Shah. Just to understand in the capex you are going to do, how much production is expected from that particular Gujarat JV? And how you elaborate or I mean over the years how you split it, expectation of production?

Management: Expectation of production from Gujarat JV, as I said, that assessment is that once we start after all the clearances and all, it shows the potential of 2 lakh tons in first 12 months.

Piyush Shah : So how many years it will be going to continue, expectation of continuation of production? Maybe 2 lakhs first year but afterwards?

Management: It is very difficult to answer at this stage because I mean what kind of -- how long will you continue with open cast? When you have to go underground and what will be the nature of that seam? So that is why, you cannot say right now that what will happen but potential is 9.5 million ton, 9.5 million tons of reserves are there. And let us see how it gets converted to production.

Piyush Shah : What is the -- as per past experience, what is an average life of a particular mine to dig ahead up to economical viable or whatever viable?

Management: It all depends. Most of our mines are 120 years old.

Piyush Shah : 120 years old. So any mine as of now has been depleted and you are not supposed to go further for that?

Management: So far no.

Anant Mundra: This is Anant Mundra from Mytemple Capital. Sir, just wante

d to understand until when do we

have our mine leases? Like when do they expire? Is anything coming for renewal?

Management: Leases are already renewed by the state governments. Some are up to 2042 and some are up to 2050 and some are up to 10 years by 2032 like that. Different leases are being renewed up to different periods.

Anant Mundra: So whenever there is a renewal, do we have to pay any additional royalty or premium?

Management: No, not like that. No, nothing.

Anant Mundra: It has been going on since ?

Management: Yes.

Analyst: Sir, I had a question just on that. You have seen that NMDC and Nalco also have made provision for additional royalty. That additional whenever the leases have been renewed. So are we facing any similar increase in royalty rates or for us it is normal? And what is exactly the rate of royalty that we are paying right now?

Manganese Ore (India) Limited

June 16, 2023

Page 16 of 17

Management: Actually we do not face any problem with the state governments because both the state governments of Maharashtra and MP are our stakeholders. We got full cooperation from the state government. Then there is no problem with these renewals of leases. And as far as this royalty is concerned, it is 5% of the sale value and there is a component of DMF and NMET. DMF is 30% of the royalty and then NMET 2%. It is like that. And where the blocks are all around 17A, there is a certain doubling of the royalty like that. We have not faced any problem from state governments.

Analyst: So you are saying basically including DMF and NMET it should come to about 7% and some blocks you are saying there can be an additional royalty. Is that correct?

Management: Yes, if it is granted under 17A, there are certain doubling of like that. It depends whether you go like that.

Analyst: Okay. 6.6% 6.6% yes.

Analyst: Sir, just one more question for you. Can you throw some light on your profit distribution after the net profit which is deployed in the recapacity or expansion of projects, the remaining is

distributed totally or it is retained with you for that matter? Say INR100 crores is there so net profit, so how much you are going for expansion and how much you are distributing as a dividend or something?

Management: This year we have retained, distributed 30% and the 70% is retained. So that is for the basically increasing the value of the company.

Analyst: So this will be the ongoing process for the dividend distribution policy and retaining the profit?

Management: It will depend on what situation is there next year and how much the capital requirement is there.

Management: Not necessarily because with this even turnover would be going up.

Analyst: Yes, that is why I am asking.

Management: So maybe that as percentage you can see it is same but the amount for distribution is more.

Analyst: Okay, thanks.

Analyst: Sir just to add this to the question sir of course you have paid as high as you say Rs. 7 dividend when the net profit was not much different from last year so is it because of higher capex you paid lower dividend from last year I mean did you skip 30% formula or how is it?

Management: These are all policy things, how much we have to distribute and how much we have to go for capex. But because we have to think about what kind of foreign exchange we are spending when we are importing manganese ore. So we have to look at that also.

Analyst: you have paid much higher dividend earlier, where the profit is not very different

Manganese Ore (India) Limited

June 16, 2023

Page 17 of 17

Management: It is not about the profit, it is about what you are looking at future, that 300 million ton and preparing yourself for that. If you do not invest now, perhaps you would not be doing the import substitution even for manganese ore.

Analyst: That's why I asked this question

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Management: Thank you.

Analyst: And any plan on buy back sir this year, 1 year period is also now over

Management: Can we have the last question please?

Analyst: We do not have any mine under Section 17A, do we have any?

Management: We still have.

Analyst: So in that I think the royalty will increase right?

Management: It depends actually.

Analyst: I mean that is codified like it is there or it is a bilateral negotiation with the state government?

Management: No, actually so far whatever we are operating that is as per these royalty 5% and DMF 30% and NMET 2% it is like that.

Analyst: So far you have not faced any increase?

Management: No.

Moderator: Yes, I think most of the questions are done. So I will just extend a vote of thanks right now. So we have come to the concluding session of the event and on behalf of Antique Stock Broking, I would really like to extend a heartfelt gratitude to the honourable CMD Ajit -ji and the senior management team of MOIL for taking time out of their busy schedule. They flew in from Nagpur today morning so pretty hectic for them and being present on this occasion and providing their insights and thoughts about the company's plans for the future.

I would also like to thank all the analysts and investors who participated in this event for their insightful questions and their contribution in helping us make this event a grand success. Also, I would like to acknowledge the efforts taken by our entire team of Antique Stock Broking, Bharti Ponda who is a corporate access person who helped put together this event and also the event management team led by Sanjay -ji for the last minute changes etcetera and for organizing this event so smoothly.

So now lunch will be served. I request everyone to please join us for lunch. Thank you all and I look forward to your continued support even from the management and from the investor committee for future events. Thank you.

Call: Nov 2023

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CS/NSE -BSE/ 2023-24/228 Date : 23.11.2023

To,
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Bandra Kurla Complex, Bandra (East),
Mumbai – 400053

To,
Listing Department
BSE Limited
Phiroze Jeejeebhoy Towers
Dalal Street
Mumbai - 400001
Sub: Investors' and Analysts' Meet – 2023 - Transcript.

Dear Sir/Madam,

Further to our letter no. CS/NSE -BSE/2023 -24/218 dated 18th November , 2023 regarding
“Investors' and Analysts' Meet – 2023” , it is to inform that the transcript of the said Meet [dated
17.11.2023] has been uploaded on our website as detailed hereunder:

www.moil.nic.in Investor R elation Disclosures under Reg. 46 and 47 of SEBI LODR
Regulation, 2015 Analysts / Institutional investor meet 17/11/2023 - Investors and
Analysts Meet -2023 (Transcript)

The transcript is enclosed as Annexure -I.

This is for your kind information and record please.

Thanking you,

Yours faithfully/ Hkonh;
For MOIL Limited/ d`Rks EkkW;Yk fykfEkVsM

Neeraj Dutt Pandey/
(Ukhjt nRr ik.Ms;)
(Company Secretary & Compliance Officer)/
(dEiuh lfpOk lg vuqikyu vf/kdkjh)

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"Manganese Ore (India) Limited
Investors and Analysts Meet"
November 17, 2023

MANAGEMENT : MR. AJIT KUMAR SAXENA – CHAIRMAN CUM MANAGING DIRECTOR
MR. RAKESH TUMANE – DIRECTOR FINANCE
MS. USHA SINGH – DIRECTOR HUMAN RESOURCES & A/C – DIRECTOR COMMERCIAL
MR. M.M. ABDULLA – DIRECTOR PRODUCTION AND PLANNING
MR. NEERAJ PANDEY – COMPANY SECRETARY
MR. JAY KALA – DEPUTY GENERAL MANAGER

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November 17, 2023

Page 2 of 19

Moderator : A request to everyone to have a seat, please. Thank you. On behalf of IDBI Capital, I would like to thank MOIL for giving us this opportunity to organize this event. I would like to call on stage Mr. A.K. Saxena, who's the Chairman cum Managing Director; Mr. Rakesh Tumane, who's the Director of Finance; Usha Singh, who's the Director of HR; Mr. M.M. Abdulla, who's the Director of Production; N.D. Pandey, Company Secretary; and Jay Kala, DGM Marketing.

Thank you, sir, and warm welcome on behalf of IDBI Capital and Analyst and Investor present. I would like to call Mr. A.K. Saxena sir to just have a brief introduction, and then we can start.

Ajit Saxena: So good morning, everyone. Before we start, I would like to introduce my team: the farthest, Mr. Rakesh Tumane, Director of Finance; Madam Usha Singh, Director Personnel -- Director HR and Additional Charge of Director Commercial; Mr. Abdulla, Director of Production & Planning; and my Company Secretary, Mr. Neeraj Dutt Pandey; and assisting me from my office is Mr. Jay Kala.

So good afternoon, everyone, and we are really thankful to all of you for joining us in this Investors' and Analysts' Meet of MOIL. We offer our heartfelt gratitude to all the investors and analysts who have reposed faith in MOIL. As a part of proceeding, after my opening remarks, we would have a brief presentation on the company's business performance, industry, and future outlook, and then we will take up question-and-answer session.

ssion.

Last, when we met sometime in mid-June, and it's good that Investors' Meet and Analysts' Meet is once again in the month of November, in a short span of 5 months. Most of you are already aware about the company and its business operation and also the manganese ore industry.

I would like to briefly highlight about our company and the developments going on. MOIL is more than 120 years old company and its history goes back to pre-independence era. All mines of the company are more than 100 years old and are still working.

It is heartening to mention that MOIL has been maintaining its leadership in manganese ore industry in the country since then. And today, it is producing more than 45% of manganese ore of the country. MOIL's shares were listed on NSE and BSE in December 2010 through disinvestment process of Government of India, in which Government of Maharashtra and Madhya Pradesh had also participated.

The company has also set up an EMD plant, that is at electrolytic manganese dioxide, which is the only plant of EMD in India. The plant fulfils the requirement of dry cell battery, pharmaceuticals. Between 2016 and 2022, the company has bought back shares worth more than INR2,000 crores.

In the year 2017, the company has also issued bonus shares in the ratio of 1:1. There was also offer for sales by the Government of India in the year 2017. Present shareholding of Government of India in MOIL is 53.35% and the state government of Maharashtra and Madhya Pradesh holding up 5.96% and 5.38%,

respectively. Remaining 35.3% shares are held by public and other institutions.

State of Maharashtra and Madhya Pradesh being a promoter of company and extend their full support for MOIL in carrying out different operations and that adds to the strength of company. You'll be very happy to know that leases of MOIL have been extended up to next decade and beyond even that, that is up to 2032 and 2042. You'd appreciate that this is the biggest strength for any mining company. Q

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Manganese Ore (India) Limited

November 17, 2023

Page 3 of 19

Coming to manganese ore market. I would like to share the government had set a target of Indian steel production capacity to be around 300 million ton by the year 2030. This augurs well for manganese ore market also, as it is an essential ingredient for making steel.

Currently, manganese ore consumption in India is around 7 million tons, which includes manganese ore required for export of manganese-based ferro alloy from the country. By 2030, it is envisaged to exceed 11 million tons as per National Steel Policy 2017. This clearly speaks volumes about the opportunities that lies ahead of MOIL.

It is most heartening to share that the MOIL has not only recognized the opportunity but has gone all, all out to make the most of it. The figures say it all. I'll just highlight a few of the achievements this year. MOIL has achieved best ever 6 monthly productions in April to September 2023, and that is 8.15 lakh million -- metric ton, registering a significant growth of 45% over corresponding period last year.

You'll be happy to know that the first quarter of the financial year, which is April to June 2023, was the best ever quarter since inception of the company and we are sure that the current quarter, which is Q3 of this financial year, is going to exceed that.

I'm glad to inform you that in the first 10 months of the current calendar year itself, MOIL has produced 13.28 lakh tons of manganese ore, which is highest ever production of MOIL in any calendar year since inception. So 13.28 million ton -- lakh ton and this is with 2 months still left with us.

Third thing is that the company has also recorded best-ever 6-monthly sales performance at 7.57 lakh tons during April to September '23, registering a growth of 54% over CPLY. Revenue from operation dur

ing the

first half of FY '24 was at about INR727 crores, which is 19% higher over CPLY. Giving utmost thrust to exploration, the company has carried out exploratory core drilling of 41,000-odd meters in the first 7 months of financial year '23, which is 2.7x of CPLY. This will help definitely -- this will help the company add manganese ore reserves and resources in its existing leases and also open new mines wherever potential is found.

In financial year 2023 also, the company carried out exploration of 41,000 meters which is the highest ever exploration done by the company since its inception and considering it as a backbone for the company, MOIL has set an ambitious exploration target of 70,000 meters in the current financial year. And in 7 months, we have explored 41,837 meters.

The company is focusing on both brownfield as well as greenfield projects to enhance the production by increasing the productivity of existing mines and exploring mining opportunities in other states and other geographies.

Recently, another feather is added in the company's hat. That is -- MOIL has been given the go ahead for carrying out exploration in 218 square kilometres area -- of area in Chhattisgarh. So with that, MOIL has signed an MOU with the CMDC, that is Chhattisgarh Mineral Development Corporation, for carrying out manganese ore mining in the state and this area has been -- this area of 218 square kilometre has been given to MOIL for further exploration. Q

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Manganese Ore (India) Limited

November 17, 2023

Page 4 of 19

So friends, MOIL is having skilled manpower working in its both underground as well as open cast mines and considering the environment concerned. More than 70% production is coming through underground mines. The management of the company is very experienced and you can repose full faith on them.

The current performance of the company shows that it gives -- it is working in the right direction, and MOIL will achieve greater heights in coming years. Importantly, I want to convey my thanks to all the analysts, investors and other stakeholders who have reposed utmost faith and confidence in the company, which is reflected in share prices of company.

You must be aware that during April to November '23 period, the share prices of MOIL has increased by more than 80 %. The company has concrete growth plans for the foreseeable future also, and I'm sure the investors' confidence and interest in MOIL share will continue as has been seen in recent past.

With this, I would request my colleague, Mr. Jay Kala, to take forward his presentation and thereafter, we will have a question-and-answer session. Thank you.

Jay Kala : Very good afternoon to all of you. First of all, I thank all for joining us in this Investor Meet. I'm Jay Kala, DGM Marketing at MOIL Limited. Today, I'll be sharing an overview of company's performance, growth prospect and the exciting opportunities that lie ahead. Let's start with the brief history of the company. MOIL was formed in 1962. And in 2002, it became Schedule B status. In 2010, MOIL became a listed company. In 2014, the company upgraded to Schedule A. And during this journey, in last financial year, MOIL did its highest production of 13.02 lakh tons since last 10 years.

Regarding uses of manganese ore. About 95% of manganese is used in the steel industry in the form of manganese-based ferroalloys. And this is being used in pharmaceutical, dry cell and chemical industry. Total resources of manganese ore in India is about 500 million tons, out of which MOIL having a share of only 20%. But at the same period, we contribute more than 45% of domestic production. In India, Odisha having resources of 34%; Karnataka, 25%; and Madhya Pradesh and Maharashtra each having resources of 12% where MOIL company belongs.

Regarding our operations area, MOIL is a major

producer of manganese ore in India, having a share of more

than 45%. We have 10 mines, six in the state of Maharashtra, four in the state of Madhya Pradesh. And we are the largest and you can say that only producer of high-grade manganese ore in India.

We always focus on safety of our employees. We also have the manufacturing unit, one in Balaghat, having a ferromanganese plant of 12,000 tons capacity. And the other one is electrolytic manganese dioxide plant at our Dongri Buzurg Mine in the state of Maharashtra, which is being used in pharmaceutical and chemical industry.

Before coming to performance, I want to share that we have expertise and experience management led by Shri. Ajit Kumar Saxena, Chairman cum Managing Director, MOIL Limited. In Board, we have three functional Directors, two Government of India nominee Directors and three Independent Directors with us. In terms of our performance. Last year, we did 13.02 lakh metric ton of production, which is the highest in last 10 years. This year, in first half, we made the record performance of 8.15 lakh metric ton, registering a growth of 45% over CPLY. Q

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Manganese Ore (India) Limited

November 17, 2023

Page 5 of 19

In terms of sales, we have made the record performance of 54% over CPLY in first half of current financial year. As I said, MOIL is also a manufacturer of EMD and is the only producer in India. In the production part, we made ever best six-monthly performance that is 26% over CPLY.

MOIL believes in wealth creation of investors also. You can see that in the last seven years, MOIL has given an average annual return of about 200% to its shareholders. Being a responsible corporate citizen, MOIL believes in giving back to the society what it has earned from them. We always focus on community development, health, education, and skill development. MOIL is committed to sustainability growth. We have made various efforts to protect the environment. Like we consume about 62% of our energy requirement from renewable energy and adopted zero discharge policy for protection of water environment.

MOIL is focusing and enhancing its production by way of increasing its production capacity, easy enhancement, exploration, and business expansion, which will ultimately benefit to shareholders. MOIL always emphasis on higher exploration. Last year, we did around 41,000-meter in drilling. And in first half of current year, we made about 35,000-meter core drilling, which is 3x more over CPLY. This year, we have a target of 70,000 meters core drilling.

In respect of capex. Capex is very essential for an organization. Last year, we did a capex of INR245 crores, which is near to our PAT. This year, we have targeted 20% more compared to last year, and we are very much sure that we will achieve it.

Regarding expansion of environment clearance. Up to last financial year, we had an EC of 2.01 million ton. And this year, we have taken a target of 66% more from this year, which will definitely help us to enhance the production.

Coming back to our production target. As I said earlier, we are focusing on enhancing our production and set an ambitious target of 35% higher from last year production. I'm pleased to share the development of MOIL. We have signed the MOU with GMDC to explore the possibility of manganese ore mining at Gujarat and established resources of 9.5 million ton, and we are in the process of signing the JV.

Like GMDC, MOIL signed the MOU with MPSMC for exploration. And if it is viable, MOIL will form a JV with MPSMC. In Chhattisgarh also, MOIL signed MOU with CMDC. As CMD sir said, Chhattisgarh government has granted the area of 218 square kilometres to CMDC where MOIL will carry out the exploration. And if it is viable, will form a JV with them. Also, MOIL is very much positive to sign the similar type of MOU with other states also.

o like Jharkhand, Andhra Pradesh, Karnataka , etcetera, which is in progress.

Performance of the company is reflected in its share prices. As you can see that MOIL share prices has increased by about 86% during this year from INR143 to INR265, whereas Sensex has increased around 11%, which shows the faith of shareholder in MOIL. Thank you.

Moderator: Thank you. We would like to now start with queries and questions -and-answers.

Analyst: Sir, I'm very much delighted to see your performance and looks that company in growth phase for the last two years, three years. Now within the hand of one lady Director also. So I think Laxmi will be already present in our company. It's not going to be a wire. Now one more thing, sir, as per our government Q

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Manganese Ore (India) Limited

November 17, 2023

Page 6 of 19

directive, there's more increase of lady Directors of 33% that they have been envisioned. I think you don't have at present. But in the future, I think you will consider that also, sir.

Now, sir, one more. I was observing that MOIL is a government enterprise. Promoter has been in the beginning Maharashtra. It was promoted by them. Those shares are acquired by the Government of India later on. So it would have been more prudent has your registered office been in Maharashtra, sir. But you are having somewhere in Delhi, I believe. So that was -- would it be more purposeful because you have got a lot of mining in this area around South, Chhattisgarh, and all places.

Anyway, sir, the future looks to be bright. I'm very happy about that. But one thing was coming to my mind, the battery which you're making from manganese, you could have added production of lithium also, which has been recently found in UK. So I think you should make an effort to acquire those rights before Adani takes over. Maybe Adani, maybe trying to take that also. And you are having already your paraphernalia, all doing exploration, all those things. I think all those things activities you are doing. So it will be ease of business for you to explore that also, sir. If you can do that, I think it will be rewarding to the shareholders as well as to the company, sir. This is I wanted to tell you, sir. Thank you, sir.

Ajit Saxena: Thank you. So thank you for appreciating the performance.

Analyst: It has been good, exceptionally and the growth part is very good, I'm sure. Sir, we are shareholders, too, in this company. So I believe that if you can make a shareholders' visit in some of the nearby area MOIL, it will give us more confidence in that, sir.

Ajit Saxena: Thank you for appreciating the performance. And as far as the process of Independent Directors, process is on. So very soon, we'll be having the Board completed. And our Headquarter is at Nagpur only. It is not at Delhi. So it is at Nagpur, very close to our mines. The nearest mine is 35 kilometres, the farthest mine is about 270 kilometres to 290 kilometres.

Analyst: That would have been better.

Ajit Saxena: So we are operating from Nagpur only. And your last point was regarding this lithium. So we are open to any kind of exploration or mining or even forward integration. We are looking eagerly to that. We have plans.

So I mean, it is only time when it comes to -- whenever it is open for public, the auctions are there, then perhaps we will be participating.

Analyst: Yes, sir. Adani should not take over from them because he is expanding in all areas, sir.

Ajit Saxena: So we are open to any kind of geography and any kind of elements. We also have identified certain areas. And about the shareholders' visit to MOIL, we can definitely organize it. Or if anyone of you want to do it in a group, you have your own plan, then you can definitely inform to our PR or to my office. So most welcome any point of time to visit your company. Thank you.

Renjith: Hi, sir.

I'm Renjith from Mahindra Mutual Fund. Congrats on a good set of numbers, to start with. So just wanted to understand like how is the realization panning out? Like production has been good. So how is the realization panning out and what's our outlook on that?

Ajit Saxena: It's 19% more than what we have achieved in the same period previous year, 19%. Q

MOIL LIMITED

(A Government of India Enterprise)

Manganese Ore (India) Limited

November 17, 2023

Page 7 of 19

Renjith: And what's the outlook like you feel that this kind of prices will sustain or you are seeing some pressure on that?

Ajit Saxena: Prices have definitely touched rock bottom. If you compare last, say, 18 months back, it has come down by more than 20%, 22%. So it is really there. But still, it's not a point of worry. We are working on other aspects, too. And we are definitely with same inputs, same resources, we have increased our production 45% more. And when we met last time, I said it will be double-digit growth, but now I'm confident it will be around 28% to 30% growth we'll be achieving over the previous year, which was the second highest performance

since inception. So I think we have a strength to deal with this rock bottom prices too.

Renjith: So this double-digit growth is in the volume terms, right?

Ajit Saxena: Yes.

Renjith: Okay. And sir, just wanted to understand this, in an EBITDA ton per aspect, whatever the variation in the prices? Will be able to maintain our EBITDA per ton? Is that something which we work as an organization? Is that a metric that we look at?

Rakesh Tumane : At the moment, our EBITDA is around 34%. See, the best EBITDA we achieved in a few years back was around 45%. So as the prices are going down, definitely, the EBITDA would be -- per ton would be lower. But we are trying to maintain that because our costs are not increasing in that proportion. Our cost is only increasing -- when we achieved 45% of growth in production, our cost has increased only by 5%. So our EBITDA is more or less maintained there.

Renjith: And sir, this capex number which you told INR295 crores this year, so till date, how much we have spent of that INR295 crores, which we are projecting for '24?

Ajit Saxena: I think INR142 crores, maybe -- here or there. It is around INR142 crores.

Renjith: Okay. And sir, lastly, this GMDC, you told that reserves are 9.5 million tons per annum. So what is -- when do we start this -- what can be the production per annum from this reserve? And what is the status now? When do we start seeing some sales or production from this...

Ajit Saxena: Since we met last time, we have gone a little ahead of that. We -- the certain stages are over and still a few more stages are left like getting a clearance from Board and then other institutions and then applying for EC. So I mean we have -- both the sides are positive on that. And about the production capacity, as I have mentioned even in last Investor Meet that very first year, we expect 0.2 million ton and then subsequently...

Renjith: So this will be a JV format of 50-50?

Ajit Saxena: This will be?

Renjith: JV with GMDC?

Ajit Saxena: Yes. It will be a JV format.

Renjith: 50% for... Q

MOIL LIMITED

(A Government of India Enterprise)

Manganese Ore (India) Limited

November 17, 2023

Page 8 of 19

Ajit Saxena: 51-49. I mean as it comes -- now it is proposed, 51 MOIL and 49 GMDC.

Renjith: Okay. And if you can touch upon the other capacity expansions which we are planning, what are their status, if you can elaborate on that?

Ajit Saxena: Yes. In Madhya Pradesh, we have around 17 blocks in Jhabua, Balaghat and Chhindwara, where we are doing exploration. And once it is established that we have resources there, then perhaps we'll be entering into a joint venture with Madhya Pradesh State Mining Corporation, too.

Working on same lines, w

e entered into an MoU with Chhattisgarh government on 16th of January this year.

And in October, they have allotted us 218 square kilometre area to explore further. If it is established that there is manganese ore, we would be entering into JV with them also. In addition to that, we are in -- we are interacting with the Jharkhand government, Karnataka government, then Goa about manganese ore and other ores.

Renjith: So this NPE will be like how big in terms of reserves, any number which you have?

Ajit Saxena: Unless it is -- I mean, it is still being explored.

Renjith: Okay. Even for the Chhattisgarh, it's still in exploration?

Ajit Saxena: It has -- we have got the clearance just few -- 2 weeks back.

Renjith: Okay sure sir, I will join for further question, Thank You.

Analyst: Sir, the mine lease extension that we have received, is that on payment or some royalty or anything of that sort?

Ajit Saxena: I think DPP sir tell it in detail, but it is the same terms. And royalty, etcetera, is paid after you excavate.

Analyst: So there is no additional royalty like it's there on iron ore and...

Ajit Saxena: No, no, nothing.

Analyst: Okay. And the production that you are planning to increase by 2030, more than 3 million ton that you're planning to do, does that include the JV or it's only from the existing mines that you are projecting?

Ajit Saxena: So for this year, when we are saying it is going to be nearly 30% growth over the best performance, it does not include any of the new things. It is only with the current assets.

Analyst: And what about the projected numbers that was given on the slide?

Ajit Saxena: Projected numbers even next year, we have not taken GMDC into account. Next to next year, we have taken. But we are hopeful that if things go the way we're going right now, perhaps next year, we would be adding GMDC. So that is why we are thinking that next year, we may be touching 2.2 million ton, 2.3 million ton.

Analyst: Okay. Okay. And sir, how is our production cost panning out? So basically, how is our outlook on the manpower? Are we -- is there a gradual reduction of manpower that's happening? And what's the visibility over the next 2, 3 years? Q

Ajit Saxena: Yes. There is -- I mean, it is not only reduction of manpower, it is rather rationalizing and redeploying also from one area to another where it is more productive. And also, we are recruiting only and only statutory manpower. So we have changed our -- rationalized our manpower structure. We are in the process. That is a continuous process. And that is why what Director Finance has said that our expenses are going down on that account also.

Analyst: So the cost of mining is higher if it's underground mining versus open cast. Is that...

Ajit Saxena: Definitely.

Analyst: So as and when we go deeper -- so our cost will keep increasing, right? Is that assessment correct? Because as and when we explore, we go deeper, the cost of mining would...

Ajit Saxena: See, it's always a combination of -- I mean, going deeper in one mine and then developing another mine which is open cast or which is of lesser depth. That is why -- I mean, that is the thing where we are focusing now because if you look at mines of MOIL, they all are 100, 120 years old. So it is only going down and down and down.

So now what we have -- that is our strategy. Now we are trying to develop new mines. Maybe GMDC, maybe that Jhabua -Chhindwara, maybe the Balrampur area of Chhattisgarh. So that we have a few mines working at open cast, few are working at underground. But thing is that manganese is not that -- not available in that bulk quantity that you can take a decision that leave it because it is in depth.

You have to excavate whatever be the depth. But to make it mor

e cost effectively, if you have a few more

mines working at -- as open cast for us, it gets compensated. So that is why there's a paradigm shift in our strategy that we are in the process of adding new and new mines.

Analyst: So the newer mines are all coming in JVs or even on just 100% MOIL owned mines are...

Ajit Saxena: It all depends. First, we explore. And then as the owner decides which is a state government in this case, that whether they want to allot us under Section 17 or their mining corporation wants to go for a joint venture or they ask us to adopt the auction method. So it is all -- it all depends on the owner of that mine.

Analyst: And sir, currently, all our sales are -- like are they contracted sales or do we sell on the spot? How are our sales contracts?

Ajit Saxena: It's a combination of both. It's a combination of both. Generally, we try to enter into long-term contract, but I mean, this is a big formula how much -- for long-term contract and when it is available for the open market, but it's a combination of both.

Analyst: And sir, currently, our production is concentrated over fewer mines, right? It's -- or it's distributed? So we have about 11 mines, if I'm correct.

Ajit Saxena: You are right. It is not that it is segregated or constructed on my side -- it all depends upon -- like you must be hearing Balaghat, Balaghat. Balaghat definitely is a very good mine. It's a flagship mine because of the product quality, I mean, the kind of ore which we are getting. Q

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November 17, 2023

But this year, I would like to inform you that my mine at Chikla, perhaps they will be matching the production levels of Balaghat and also the Dongri Buzurg. So there would be 2 other mines. So it all depends what kind of capacity you have, what kind of hoisting capacity you have and difficulty factors -- various difficult factors. So it's -- yes, you are right, Balaghat was producing highest. But this year, perhaps Balaghat is getting tougher competition from Chikla as well as Dongri Buzurg.

Rakesh Tumane : Please introduce yourself, we did not get your name.

Anant Mundra: Sir, I'm Anant Mundra from Mytemple Capital.

Sukhwinder Singh: Yes. My name is Sukhwinder Singh from Bajaj Holdings & Investments. A couple of questions. Like since we cater to about 45% of total sales in India, so I just wanted to know what is the quality of manganese ore we have vis-a-vis unorganized players in India?

And second, in terms of pricing, do we track any international benchmark while deciding price cuts or price hike? Because what I believe is that steel sector growth is almost about 10% to 11% in H1, but despite that, we had price cuts in the last 2, 3 months? These two questions .

Ajit Saxena: So your first question was about the grade?

Sukhwinder Singh: Quality of...

Ajit Saxena: It is -- often it is referred as percentage of manganese, okay? So you can say MOIL, it is average 30% to 33%. And nearly that is the national average, but that is not the only thing. In some mines, you get some

extra phosphorous, which may not be required. In some mines, you get iron along with that. In some mines, you get silica.

So it is not just manganese content. Manganese content -wise, if you go, then definitely a few of our mines are above national average. And our average is nearly -- is rather slightly better than national average, that is 30% to 33%. As far as prices of manganese ore vis -a-vis the growth of Indian steel industry, which is 11% and our price is going down. So there are a few features.

First of all, whatever we produce, it is being consumed, say, 95% or you say 100% is being consumed by ferro alloy producers. And what ferro alloy producers do with that? Nearly 45% to 50% of their production goes for export. So their domestic front is fine

. How they're domestic -- how their export front is playing, I mean, that also need to be seen. That is one.

Second thing is it is always the question of availability and consumption. So maybe that availability is more in first half. That is second thing. And then if you talk about the other difficulty factors of ferro alloy manufacturers, that when they want to produce, when they want to hold, when they want to keep their inventory, those are also factors which are taken into account for pricing. As far as our -- these are the factors which we take into account. And yes, we also follow certain international indices that what is our trend there. So I think that suffices your...

Sukhwinder Singh: Yes, yes. And these price hikes or price cuts, is it under long -term contracts or short term?

Ajit Saxena: No, no, we fix certain price. And based on that, those monthly -- we fix price on monthly basis month, every month. Q

MOIL LIMITED

(A Government of India Enterprise)

Manganese Ore (India) Limited

November 17, 2023

Page 11 of 19

Sukhwinder Singh: Okay. And the other question is on the resource base. Normally based on your past trend, what is the recovery

rate from the resource base? Like whatever you are exploring, how much recovery is possible...

Ajit Saxena: No relation to recovery is guaranteed, no one can, as much as I know. I think we can, say, do better, but nobody can guarantee because you may get it somewhere ahead, you may not getting just 2 feet away from there. So no one -- so far, it is not. Maybe tomorrow, you have some different technology, that is a different issue.

So you have to -- you can say it's totally blind thing. It is just going by some kind of mapping, you decide and -- with some features on the floor, you decide that this particular ore may be there. Then you start exploring, then you focus in closer areas, and then you decide, okay, this is the bed which is there. If you want further details, I think DPP Sahab can tell you better.

M. M. Abdulla: Do we know any more details regarding this exploration?

Sukhwinder Singh: No, no. I just wanted to know if recovery rate must be more than 25% from any...

M. M. Abdulla: No, you can't guarantee. Actually, the resources are different and the recovery is depending upon the method of mining how we are going to access the deposit. So many things are there.

Ajit Saxena: You can share your experience with GMDC.

M. M. Abdulla: Yes.

Ajit Saxena: If someone else has explored and did not get -- because the kind of angle which you use -- which we use for exploration, somebody explored in certain area, they did not get an environment. MOIL experts, they did it. So they changed certain -- angle they have changed and they found that manganese ore is there. So it's all, I mean, experience and technology and catching the symptoms whatever is available. Nobody can tell you what is the exact ratio.

Analyst: Just congrats on good set of numbers. Last 2 quarters has been wonderful for you. But when I look at historically, you have always guided very aggressively, but haven't kind of delivered, if I look at FY '08 or '09, you were already at 1.3 million ton, 1.4 million ton. This is the first year, which you will be crossing that number.

So what gives you confidence that this time it's different? What things you are changing so that these targets are actually achievable now? And what are the risks -- what do you think that can kind of lower these targets for you, say, in 6 months down the line, you say that these are the things which didn't happen in all these -- on the basis of these kind of critical milestones to be achieved?

Ajit Saxena: So like rightly, we have said 2008 -'09, I think it was 13.64 lakh tons. And now last year, it was 13.02 lakh tons. That's why we said, it is second highest since inception. But this year -- I mean, if you ask me what gives me confidence

now? What -- or how I can transfer this confidence to you?

I just tell you this -- if we talk about this calendar year, so that is last quarter of last financial year, that is January to March this year. Last year, performance was not very good until first nine months. And we just started -- I mean, we just planned certain things and kept a target of 4 lakh tons for that quarter. And we achieved 4.16 lakh tons I think. And then when it was achieved, then just entering in the month of April, we Q

decided that what is April and what is March, let us focus first quarter, in the same spirit as we have dealt with in the first quarter -- last quarter of last financial year.

We took this challenge and the production was 4.36 lakh tons. So that gave us confidence that yes, we can go ahead. And you just see 3Q, September figures are 8.15 lakh tons. So that simply speaks, it is more than 1.6 million tons. So when we met in the month of June, we said we'll be targeting double-digit growth. Now I'm confident it will be around 28% to 30%, around 1.7 million tons, 1.75 million tons will be there.

Now if you ask me what we have done? In fact, what we have done is, I mean, there are certain steps focusing on your employee, focusing on your enhancement of ECs, focusing on your expansion projects, focusing on your efficiency like suppose what should be the speed of my hoisting mechanism, what should be the capacity of my hoisting tub? Whether it is being fully utilized or not? So start from that small point to planning or when should I get my EC and what capacities I'm going to get in 2023-'24 or '24-'25 and onwards? So we are working on different areas. Short term, medium term as well as the long term. So that is why we are confident that unless something -- I mean, something that big happens, which is beyond our control, we are confident we'll be touching more than 1.7 million ton this year.

Analyst: One more thing. How is these targets decided? First, you kind of decide on 20%, 30% growth in, say, five years down the line and then work backwards? Or these are mine specific, and then you can accumulate these targets?

Ajit Saxena: You are right. I mean we look at the potential. In fact, one of our workshops, we addressed our employees saying, don't look at the best performance, look at your potential. So that is the way we are planning. Look at the potential and see where the potential is getting affected. See, I have a lot of -- in a particular mine, I have EC limits, but I don't have hoisting limit. So I have to focus more on hoisting limits.

So it is like we are -- as we have said that country is consuming around 7 million ton. But country is producing only 2.8 million ton, 2.9 million ton. So there's a lot of market. So that is not an issue. So where we have to focus, we have to focus how much we can produce. And then again, short term, medium term, and long term. Thank you.

Analyst: Just one more thing, sir. Historically, we have been a flat growth company in terms of volume. So what went wrong? As per you, why we were not able to achieve the targets? Just what went wrong as per you?

Ajit Saxena: I couldn't get you.

Analyst: So historically, see, I mean, last eight years, 10 years, there was never a volume growth in the company. Although the targets were always kind of -- these kinds of targets were shared even in the annual report. So what went wrong do you think which can't happen again?

Ajit Saxena: I think it's -- I mean, there's -- I mean, nothing very big. But of course, we have picked up certain pieces and learnings, and that is what is giving you a good production.

Analyst: Sure, thanks. And just lastly, the amount of cash you have and the kind of capex plans, if things go according to plans, your existing operating c

ash flow will suffice for the capex. So do you have any plans for that cash lying on the balance sheet... Q

Ajit Saxena: We definitely have plans for many things, but the only things we are looking at viability, I mean, viability over a long period of time so that we invest like the EMD is another thing. So we have to look at viability. We just cannot throw away the money. And we also, as we said, we are going for joint ventures and we are also exploring other elements. So we have plans.

Analyst: But anything on the increasing dividend payout for the company?

Ajit Saxena: Anything?

Analyst: On the dividend payouts, can that be increased now?

Ajit Saxena: That is through certain guidelines. We'll be coming back to you. And it will be something -- it must be something good because the figures are showing good.

Analyst: Sir, over the last five years, we have given four buybacks to the investors. So it's due -- I think last buyback was in '21. So it's due in '23 also. Every two years or less than two years, we are giving -- reducing the capital by buyback. So due to expansion, would it be hurting the buyback system of our...

Ajit Saxena: There are certain guidelines, we work according to that. And definitely, we need to work more on capacity expansion because we have to save a lot of foreign exchange, which is getting consumed even now. And when we have planned for going for 300 million tons, definitely. This 7-million-ton requirement is going to

get converted to 11 million tons. So we will definitely be focusing on our capex. But whatever is due as per guidelines, it'll definitely be shared with you.

Analyst: Sir, secondly, generally, as Nagpur being a hot area during the next second half, so as a result, in general, first half is always better and second half is always a weaker one due to production and heat and everything. So would it be similar way?

Ajit Saxena: Let's see.

Analyst: And sir, I must congratulate, sir, you are only the PSU which is holding an AGM in physical and online format. So it's good, sir. Only one PSU has hold AGM just like that.

Ajit Saxena: Thank you, sir. Thank you very much.

Gopal: Yes. Hi , sir. This is Gopal from SBI Life Insurance. So a couple of questions. On the pricing side, if you can highlight, how does pricing works? Whether it's just only cost of production which matters? Or do we need to see the import landed prices in the global market? What all factors decide these prices?

Ajit Saxena: It's all -- I think I addressed part of it in the previous question. Anyway, it is just international prices are one -- I mean, one indicator, but there are many more things. Inventory at our site, the season, the kind of consumption, ferroalloy production, ferroalloy exports, global steel, and stocks at port. So there are many other -- many, many factors, which we take into account.

Gopal: And how are the prices right now versus, say, the last quarter? I think it was a decline of 19% -odd?

Ajit Saxena: Prices are going down. It may be in a week, it goes up. But otherwise, at a macro level, if you look at the last 18 months, it is going down. Q

MOIL LIMITED

(A Government of India Enterprise)

Manganese Ore (India) Limited

November 17, 2023

Page 14 of 19

Gopal: Okay. And sir, in terms of cost of production, there is an increase sequentially from 6,200 to 6,500 on overall cost of production. And how do we benchmark our cost of production versus the peers in India and in the global market, where are we?

Ajit Saxena: Where from you got this figure of 6,400 or 6,500?

Gopal: Sir, just divided the cost...

Ajit Saxena: I don't think figures are correct.

Gopal: Okay, you can correct me?

Ajit Saxena: Our cost is going down, and it is -- it competes w

ith the best cost of production across the globe.

Gopal: Okay, sure. And sir, lastly, this production guidance which you are giving for next two years, three years, how much is dependent on the new mines or new JVs and all? Or is it coming from all existing mines?

Ajit Saxena: It is -- I mean, definitely, it will be depending on new mines and new joint ventures. But this year as well as next year, too, I mean, it is based on whatever we have right now in our pocket. Maybe from '25 -'26 onwards, we are adding the GMDC and other things.

Gopal: And generally, how long it takes in terms of from exploration stage to production and all?

Ajit Saxena: It may take any time. But now we are trying to see that how everything can be achieved in a record time. And we are monitoring different milestones at different level. So maybe that people have bought it in seven years, eight years from exploration to excavation. But you have given me the right parameter. I'll observe it and come back to you, maybe not in next or maybe next to next investors meet that what is the record figure, which we achieved.

Gopal: Sure, sir. And sir, right now, underground mining is like 65%, 70% for us. For next two years, will this ratio increase further or it remains like this?

Ajit Saxena: It all depends. I mean what kind of mine we add to our kitty, say GMDC. So it appears that for initial two years, three years, it may be open cast. If further exploration tells that we need to go down, we will definitely be going for underground thing.

Gopal: So current mines, which we have, I think, seven mines out of 10 mines are underground right now. And do you expect this number to go up in next two years, existing mines, I'm not talking about new mines?

Ajit Saxena: Existing mines, we are doing some kind of expansion in three mines. One is complete, that is -- there are three underground mines I'm talking about. One is Ukwa. So there, we have increased the hoisting capacity. I mean whatever you excavate, you need to take it out. So that capacity, we have increased and Balaghat and Gumgaon, two other mines, there we are in the process of increasing this hoisting capacity.

And Chikla mine, we had everything, but we did not have environment clearance. So that we got and our capacity has increased from 1.8 lakh tons to 4 lakh tons. We have got this consent to operate in the -- on 25th or 26th of October this year. So that capacity is doubled. So we are working on enhancing the environmental clearances as well as hoisting capacity. Q

MOIL LIMITED

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Manganese Ore (India) Limited

November 17, 2023

Gopal: Sure, sir. Thanks a lot for that.

Raj: Sir, Raj here from SBI Mutual Fund. Sir, just over the past decade, if we see your realization per ton, the premium over global prices have come off. So is there any change in the grade or like you mentioned a lot of other impurities and also?

Ajit Saxena: Yes, there are a lot of other parameters. And it's all -- I mean, availability -- suppose tomorrow something happens and cargoes are not available, then same manganese prices will go up and -- so it's plenty of factors which effect.

Raj: Okay. Sir, there might be quarterly aberrations. But I'm just saying annually over the past decades, steadily, we see some decline in the realization premium. So has to do with grade deterioration?

Ajit Saxena: If you look at last one year, 1.5 years, it is there. But before that, it was not. So you cannot say it is going to be like this. It has to go up, whether it happens in this quarter or next quarter. Because right now, certain alloys are being purchased at INR60,000 to INR62,000, which were being purchased INR1,20,000 per ton just three years back.

Raj: Okay, sure. Thanks.

Nitin Karwa: Hi, sir. My name is Nitin Karwa. I have a quick question with respect to I wanted to have your colour on the

government impetus or policy changes that have been happening over the recent past to kind of give you a heads up to go ahead with exploration aggressively. So your comment on that and is this something very recent? And do you see this as a consistent policy sort of for the future, there will be added incentives coming through from the government to have companies like yours to explore aggressively?

Ajit Saxena: Look, I mean the way we are planning, we as a country, when we are planning to go for \$5 trillion and all we have to go take up mining very rigorously. And so far, we have mined only bulk materials. Now you must be hearing a lot about lithium, nickel, cobalt, and whatnot.

So definitely, it requires a lot of exploration. So, exploration is being encouraged by the government in all aspects. And for any mining company as well as for developing the mining sector and company, you need to explore.

Nitin Karwa: So are there any sort of rebate or reimbursement of these exploration costs from the government at this stage?

Ajit Saxena: I think...

Nitin Karwa: There was some announcement or some policy changes?

M.M Abdulla : There is an inmate a fund created by these royalties, etcetera, by the government. If you go -- if you are exploring and giving back that block to the state government, and if that proposal is passed by inmate, then you can get back that -- whatever you have expenditure on the exploration.

Nitin Karwa: So this would be there for your Chhattisgarh or future MP or future MP on Chhattisgarh?

M.M Abdulla : No, no. We are not going through inmate that route because... Q

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Manganese Ore (India) Limited

November 17, 2023

Ajit Saxena: Suppose government ask you to -- or it is decided mutually that you explore certain area. You have explored. You have given your report to that state government and you get your money reimbursed by inmate fund.

Job is over. But suppose that area is allotted to you and you do the exploration and something is -- something of that kind is assured that if it is there, then you will be getting that mine, then terms are different.

So what you have heard is inmate fund. So that is -- I mean people can take the exploration job their part is being reimbursed by that inmate fund. And you have to give back the reports back to the concerned government.

Nitin Karwa: So we are not going through that basically?

Ajit Saxena: We are doing with our resources and the area is allotted to us.

Nitin Karwa: Okay, okay. Thanks.

Kirtan Mehta: This is Kirtan Mehta from BOB Capital Markets. One question on the cost structure. Could you indicate your current cost of production? And what are the typical cost elements? And how is the breakup of the cost element?

Ajit Saxena: Do you think it can be given?

Kirtan Mehta: Just a historical track record if you can share?

Ajit Saxena: We are definitely doing much better than past. And as you have noted in last investor meeting, even before that, you have all have very good data with you. Earlier, I think it was -- the cost of employee was 54%. It was -- now it is going down. And we are recruiting only statutory manpower. And again, if -- as since we are getting more volumes, so my per ton cost is definitely going down.

Kirtan Mehta: Right. Second question was about the seven years exploration where we are aiming to bring it down substantially. Exploration to excavation, the way you mentioned. What are the typical stages involved in this process? And where are the areas where we can see possibility of bringing it down.

Ajit Saxena: When I say seven years, it does have not been in exactly seven years. At times, it is much more than that. A

different stage , I think DPP sir will tell from exploration to excavation what all regulations and what our permissions are to be taken. DPP sir,

please.

M.M Abdulla : See, the exploration quantum depends upon the area which you are going to explore and how the ore body is, whether it is on the surface or it is deep seated. That depends how much time it will take for exploration .

And then once the ore body is established, then you have to go for TFR and the method of mining.

And then you go for these statutory permissions like EC and getting approval of mining plan from Indian Bureau of Mines like that. That all depends. You cannot say this much time is exactly we can allot.

Kirtan Mehta: Which is the stage where we can think about compressing the time or reducing the time period to excavation, which are the potential areas?

Management: If you deploy one machine, suppose 100 meters of drilling is done in a month, then if you deploy two machines, then 200 meters can be done. That all depends on the area. You cannot just say, this much is the Q

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Manganese Ore (India) Limited

November 17, 2023

Page 17 of 19

time required. That all depends on the area and the quality of ore body and the geologic construction of the ore body.

Kirtan Mehta: Thank you. And just one last question. We were talking about sort of moving from a bulk mining of a bulk material to something like lithium or cobalt. Would it require sort of involving additional expertise or tie-up with another partners as well while we explore to do that?

Ajit Saxena: Look, we have -- we are the one who is having experience of working or operating with both kind of finding open cast as well as underground. And our mines are as deep as 400 meters. And you can say, one, one and half years' time, we are going to the level of 650 meters. So we have competence on both the mines. And since it is a new area, so it's -- I mean all the mining kind of thing and mining, we have exposure to both the type of mines. So I think we are fit to compete or fit to demand our share.

Kirtan Mehta: Sure, sir. All the best.

Ajit Saxena: Thank you.

Analyst: [Inaudible]

Ajit Saxena: Sir, there must be, and there should be .

Analyst: [Inaudible]

Ajit Saxena: Yes, we have Mini ratna company.

Analyst: Government is running many other cases...

Ajit Saxena: I mean there -- we have a Mini ratna company, and we have seen our performance.

Analyst: Sir, has the first half of this year results have been declined, September ending -- April to September?

Ajit Saxena: I could not -- please?

Analyst: April to September?

Ajit Saxena: Declared. Declared.

Analyst: They are declared?

Ajit Saxena: Declared.

Analyst: And you mentioned that you will be registering a 30% growth this year. So, the results are reflecting because the quantity you mentioned was 8.5 lakh tons in the half year?

Ajit Saxena: It is till 30th September to 8.15 lakh ton. I'm just talking about production figure.

Analyst: Yes, yes.

Ajit Saxena: And it is 45% higher than last year same period, CPLY. Q

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November 17, 2023

Page 18 of 19

Analyst: The production quantity?

Ajit Saxena: Production.

Analyst: And the top line EBITDA and PAT?

Ajit Saxena: And EBITDA is around 34%. Sales also registered a record a growth of around 54% over previous year. And I just remind you, previous year was the second highest -- the second -best performance.

Analyst: Yes.

Ajit Saxena: So it is definitely -- you can say it is over the best one. That was 13.64 on 2008 or '09, as you have mentioned. So it is -- I mean this is really a remarkable performance. Even if we are saying that market good, bad, this, that, but we have sold around 7.75 lakh tons. While last year, we have sold around 11,77,000.

Analyst: Very true. So we are on track and course for 30% growth, at least not only this year, but what I read from you

r body language, even going forward next year?

Ajit Saxena: Yes. The next year -- this year, if we do around 30 and 30 is on slightly on lower side what I'm expecting...

Analyst: Better to keep it conservative?

Ajit Saxena: So this year, 30, then next year, yes, definitely 20 plus.

Analyst: Definitely 20. Thank you and all the best.

Ajit Saxena: Thank you.

Analyst: Sir, it is possible to find out to EC different, our EC differences is about 3.5 million ton. But our projection is this 2.5?

Ajit Saxena: ECs, whether you talk about EC, whether you talk about investment in your enhancing your hosting capacity. Nothing is done for today only. It is done keeping long term in mind. Suppose I have to add that hosting capacity in a mine, it will take three years.

And at the same time, I want to enhance my EC. So I will not take my EC based on today's performance because itself is a long run process. So I will take it with whatever my capacity and what I'm going to add a little more. So it is like that. So saying that I'm having this much of EC and having equivalent hosting capacity is a very rare kind of thing. And again, that is your runoff mine.

So out of that runoff mine, how much you get -- how much ore you get that again depends on Mother Earth.

I think your questions -- answer is clear your doubt.

Analyst: Sir, good afternoon. Over here. Sir, you have mentioned that most of your mines are already 100 years old, currently active ones. So can you just help us with extraction ratio, what could be the possible or the probable life of these mines, like how much more can you extract out of them?

Ajit Saxena: See exploration in new areas as well as exploration in current mines. These are continuous activities. So as long as we keep getting it through those sites or through those mines, and it is safe and it is -- and our Q

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Manganese Ore (India) Limited

November 17, 2023

Page 19 of 19

technology measure s that we'll definitely be doing it because this is not an element which is readily available or which is easily available. So you just cannot leave anything.

Analyst: Sir but based on like what you have said for the new mines also that you do potentially have an idea about the potential results, which they are having it. And based on the extraction rate, there is a life of the mine that how much?

Ajit Saxena: That is, for example, I know about certain mine, it is 9.5 million ton as of now. Maybe when we start doing the work, still I mean going area -wise, maybe I'm getting some area in neighbourhood and explore it. Maybe when we go deeper and deeper, we come to know it is not nine, it is around 11 or 12 or 13.

Analyst: So currently, on the mines, which we are working based on your current assessment, can we have that kind of life for the existing mines, which are more profitable for us?

Ajit Saxena: No, I couldn't get you, please?

Analyst: Based on your current extraction and assessment on which you are doing it ongoingly, can we have the sense that for the mines, which we are very productive and the resources which are very rich, what could be the probable life going forward for that?

Ajit Saxena: Cannot be predicted like that because there are certain mines which my Director of Production when he joined somebody said, in the next five years, it will be closed. But he has completed his career, it is still not closed.

M.M Abdulla : You see at Balaghat mine; we were earlier working at a depth of 300 meters, then we proved up to 500 meters, then we proved up to 750, then we proved up 1,000 meters. Even after 1,000 meters also, the ore body is not exhausted. Even if you go deeper, then there is possibility of getting the ore body.

That you cannot say at this time, whatever results and resources are available at this moment, we are planning according to that. The exploration

is a continuous process and the mining is also a continuous process.

Analyst: Thank you very much.

Analyst: [Inaudible] .

Ajit Saxena: I think we can get it. If not now, maybe -- we will give you.

Moderator: In the interest of time, we would like to close the question -and-answer session. On behalf of MOIL Limited and IDBI Capital, I would like to thank everyone for a such an interactive session. Thank you everyone. So please help yourselves at lunch. Thank you and have a nice day.

Ajit Saxena: Thank you. Q

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Call: Aug 2024

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CIN No: L99999MH1962GOI012398
CS/NSE -BSE/ 2024-25/ 145 Date : 27.08.2024

To,
The GM (Listing),
National Stock Exchange of India Ltd,
Exchange Plaza, Plot No.C-1, G Block,
Bandra Kurla Complex, Bandra (East),
Mumbai – 400053

To,
Listing Department
BSE Limited
Phiroze Jeejeebhoy Towers
Dalal Street
Mumbai - 400001
Sub: Investors' and Analysts' Meet - Transcript.

Dear Sir/Madam,

Further to our letter no. CS/NSE -BSE/2024-25/141 dated 23rd August, 2024 regarding "Investors' and Analysts' Meet ", it is to inform that the tran script of the said Meet [dated 23 .08.2024] has been uploaded on our website as detailed hereunder:

www.moil.nic.in

Investor Relation Disclosures under Reg. 46 and 47 of SEBI LODR
Regulation, 2015 Analysts / Institutional investor meet 23/08/2024 - Investors and
Analysts Meet - 2024 (Transcript)

Web link (Transcript): <https://www.moil.nic.in/userfiles/file/InvRel/MOIL -IAMeet23082024.pdf>

The transcript is enclosed as Annexure -I.
This is for your kind information and record please.

Thanking you,

Yours faithfully/
Hkonh;
For MOIL Limited/ d`Rks EkkW;Yk fykfEkVsM

Neeraj Dutt Pandey/
(Ukhjt nRr ik.Ms;)
(Company Secretary & Compliance Officer)/
(dEiuh lfpOk lg vuqikyu vf/kdkjh)

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Annexure -I

Page 1 of 19

"Manganese Ore (India) Limited
Investors and Analysts Meet"
August 23 , 2024

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MANAGEMENT : M R. AJIT KUMAR SAXENA – CHAIRMAN AND
MANAGING DIRECTOR – MOIL LIMITED
MR. RAKESH TUMANE – DIRECTOR , FINANCE – MOIL
LIMITED
MS. USHA SINGH – DIRECTOR , HUMAN RESOURCES –
MOIL LIMITED
MR. M.M. ABDULLA – DIRECTOR , PRODUCTION AND
PLANNING – MOIL LIMITED
MS. RASHMI SINGH – DIRECTOR COMMERCIAL –
MOIL LIMITED
MR. ASHWINI DAS – AGM FINANCE , MOIL LIMITED

MODERATOR : MR. PALLAV AGARWAL – ANTIQUE STOCK BROKING

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August 24, 2024

Page 2 of 19

Pallav Agarwal : Hello. Yes, good afternoon, ladies and gentlemen. I am Pallav Agarwal. On behalf of Antique Stock Broking, I would like to extend a warm welcome to the investor and analyst fraternity gathered here on the occasion of the Annual Investor Meet 2024 of Manganese Ore (India) Limited, MOIL. So today we have with us the gracious presence of Shri Ajit Kumar Saxena, the Chairman cum Managing Director. We welcome you, sir.

Along with him, we have the top management team today, comprising of Shri Rakesh Tumane, the Director of Finance, Ms. Usha Singh, the Director HR, Rashmi Singh, the Director Commercial and Mr. M. M. Abdullah, Director Production and Planning. So firstly, we would like to thank you all for taking time out today out of your busy schedules and making it here to understand the exciting journey of MOIL. I would also like to acknowledge the efforts of the CMD and the MOIL team for the exemplary performance and which is reflected in the stock returns as well.

I have been tracking the company and have invested in the stock and it has done very well. And we are very confident that the company would again transit to a higher orbit going ahead. So without much ado, I would like to invite the CMD and his team to share their thoughts. So please come over, sir.

Ajit Kumar Saxena: So good afternoon, everyone. Before we start, I would like to introduce my team. Mr. Rakesh Tumane, Director of Finance, Mr. M. M. Abdullah, Director of Production and planning, Ms. Usha Singh, Director HR and Ms. Rashmi Singh, Director Commercial. We are really thankful to all of you for joining us in this investors and analysts meet today. We offer our heartfelt gratitude to all the investors and analysts who have reposed faith in MOIL. As a part of proceeding, after my opening remarks, we will have a brief presentation on the company's business, business performance, industry and future outlook, and then we will have a question and answer session. In the last financial year, we have met thrice on different occasions, and I am happy that we are meeting again today in this financial year.

Hope most of you are already aware about the company and its business operation and also the

Manganese Ore industry currently. I would like to briefly highlight about MOIL and the development going on in the company. MOIL is a more than 120-year-old company and its history goes back to pre-independence day.

All mines of the company at present are more than 100 years old and still operating. MOIL shares were listed on NSE and BSE in December 2010 through this investment process of Government of India, in which Government of Maharashtra and Government of Madhya Pradesh had also participated. In the year 2017, the company has also issued bonus shares in the ratio of 1:1.

There was also offer for sales by the Government of India in the year 2017. Between 2016 and 2022, the company has bought back shares worth more than INR2,000 crores. Present shareholding of Government of India in MOIL is 53.35% and State Government of Maharashtra and Madhya Pradesh holding around 5.96% and 5.38% respectively. Remaining 35.31% shares are held by public and other institutions. MOIL has 10 mines, which includes 7 underground mines and 3 open cast mines. Q

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Manganese Ore (India) Limited

August 24, 2024

Page 3 of 19

More than 70% production is coming through underground mines. It is heartening to mention that MOIL has been maintaining its leadership in manganese ore industry in the country. At present, MOIL is producing more than 52% of manganese ore produced in the country. So, it is the largest manganese ore producer of the country. Besides, MOIL also produces Electrolytic Manganese Dioxide, which is the only EMD plant in India and this EMD is used for batteries, pharmaceuticals, etc. State of Maharashtra and Madhya Pradesh being a promoter of the company and thus extend their full support for MOIL in carrying out different operations and that adds to the strength of the company.

You will be happy to know that leases of MOIL have been extended not only to the next decade but beyond that. Few mines are up to 2032 and few up to 2042. And I think you would appreciate that this is the biggest strength for any mining company.

Coming to manganese ore market, I would like to share that Government has set a target of Indian steel production capacity to be around 300 million tons by the year 2030. This augurs well for manganese ore market also as it is an essential ingredient for making steel. Currently, manganese ore consumption in India is around 8 million tons, which includes manganese ore required for export of manganese-based ferroalloys from the country.

By 2030, it is envisaged to exceed 11 million tons as per National Steel Policy. This clearly speaks volumes about the opportunities that lie ahead of MOIL. At present, MOIL is producing around 1.7-1.8 million ton, while the rest of India is producing around similar quantity 1.7-1.8 million ton and remaining quantity is being imported. It is most heartening to share that MOIL has not only recognised the opportunity, but

it also has gone all out to make the most of it. The

figures say it all. I will just highlight a few of the achievements of the FY 24.

Best it is, FY24 the certain highlights is best ever production of 1.756 lakhs tons of manganese ore, which is higher by 35% year on year basis. Best ever sales of 15.36 lakhs tons of manganese ore, that is 30% higher year on year basis. Best ever turnover of INR1449.42 crores, 8% higher on year-on-year basis. Best ever exploration done, core drilling done, that is 87,661 metres against target of 80,000 metres and that also shows a growth of 100% year on year basis. Capex, that is capital expenditure of INR316 crore was done, which is more than profit after tax of the year.

You will be happy to know that the first quarter of the financial year has similar feathers, and the same stellar performance continued, that is April to June was the best ever quarter since inception of the company in various fronts. During the quarter, MOIL has recorded it is the best ever quarterly revenue from operation, that is INR492 crores, that is 30% higher on year-on-year basis as compared to last Q1 of FY24.

Best ever quarterly sales of 4.53 lakhs metric tons, which is 15% higher year on year basis. Best ever first quarter manganese ore production of 4.7 lakh tons, which is 8% higher and best quarterly exploratory core drilling of 30,000 cubic metres, 30,000 running metres, almost 1.56 times of year-on-year basis. This will help the company adding in its existing manganese ore resources, reserves and resources and opening new mines wherever potential is viable. Q

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August 24, 2024

The company is focusing on brownfield as well as greenfield projects to enhance the production by increasing the productivity of existing mines and exploring mining opportunities in other states and other geographies. In this direction, as already informed to you earlier, MOIL has already signed MOU with Gujarat Mineral Development Corporation, Gujarat State Enterprise to explore the possibility of mining of manganese ore in the Pani area of Gujarat. Exploration is done and we are nearing the signing of joint venture with GMDC with having 51% shares with MOIL.

MOIL has also signed MOU with Chhattisgarh Mineral Development Corporation for the exploration, followed by mining. MOIL has received the go ahead for carrying out exploration in 218 square kilometres area in the Nilkanthpur block, Balrampur, Chhattisgarh. MOIL has started exploration on 1st of June this year, 2024.

Further, MOIL has also signed tripartite MOU with the government of MP and MP State Mining Corporation Limited to explore the possibility of manganese ore in four districts, in four districts of MP, that is Jhabua, Jabalpur, Balaghat and around more than 1300 square kilometres area has been allocated to MOIL for exploration. MOIL has completed exploration works in Chhindwara and exploration in Balaghat area is under process. Exploration indicates availability of manganese ore in these areas and there are positive responses.

Friends, MOIL is having skilled manpower working in its both underground as well as open cast mines. The management of company is very well experienced, and you can impose full faith on them. The current performance of the company shows that it is working in the right direction wherein we have registered a growth of 35%.

This year we are targeting a growth of around 14 %-15% over the last year. Also , the exploration targets have been increased by 25% and so the other targets. The company has concrete growth plans and by the year 2030 when country is requiring around 11 billion tons of manganese ore, we have targeted that we would be contributing to the tune of 32% of requirement of country which is right now around 20%-21%.

So, with this I would

request my, I put full stop to my address, and I request my colleague Mr.

Ashwini Das, AGM Finance to take forward this presentation and thereafter we will have a question -and-answer session.

Thank you. Thank you one and all.

Ashwini Das: Thank you sir. Good morning , everyone. I am Ashwini Das, AGM Finance working at MOIL. I extend a warm welcome to each one of you and express my sincere gratitude for taking the time today. Your presence here is a testament to your confidence and interest in our company and our business. Over the past one -year MOIL has taken various significant strides in the areas of production, sales, exploration and environmental clearance.

We are excited to share with you not only what we have achieved so far , but also the strategic initiatives we are pursuing to drive our next phase of growth. In today's presentation we will cover our current performance, our growth strategy and the exciting developments in the horizon. But more than that we aim to provide you with a clear understanding of how we intend to

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Manganese Ore (India) Limited

August 24, 2024

to create sustainable value and why we believe that now is the time to invest, be invested in our company.

So, without further ado let's dive into the details. MOIL is the largest manganese ore producer in India. As our CMD sir has already mentioned it is the first CPSC to install windmill projects in India also. And it is the only company in India to produce electrolytic dioxide manganese.

Electrolytic manganese dioxide that is EMD. First of all, let's discuss about what are the uses of manganese ore.

Manganese ore has several uses. Most important and primary it is used in steel and industrial sector. In steel production it is used as a deoxidizing agent to remove oxygen and sulphur impurities to improve the steel durability and strength .

Manganese is also used in steel alloys to enhance the hardness, tensile strength and resistance to wear and impact. Manganese is also used in other industrial sector, which is in alkaline batteries, lithium-ion batteries and also pigment of paints and ceramics and also it is used as a micronutrient for fertilizer which helps in plant growth.

Since manganese is a critical component in steel production the demand for steel directly affects the manganese ore prices. Higher the steel production leads to increased demand and potentially higher prices. With this we move to the manganese ore global market scenario. The global

market is very competitive with significant players from the country of South Africa, Gabon, Australia and China.

India contributes only 5% of the total manganese ore produced in the world. MOIL subtraction are primarily focused within India and it continues to explore ways to enhance its global footprint though it remains more prominently domestically. This is an overview of our Indian market. We can see that around 5.6 million tons of manganese ore are being imported which is a significant growth opportunity for MOIL. MOIL can achieve and contribute to the country's production demand by increasing its production and production capacity by expanding its manganese ore reserves and resources. This is an overview of the reserves and resources in India.

MOIL holds only 21% of the total reserves and resources. Before going into details let me explain to you what are resources and what are reserves. Resources are identified as mineral occurrences which reasonably prospect for future extraction. However, reserves are economically viable portion of the resource that can be extracted. Exploration of these reserves and resources forms the basis of any mining industry. Although MOIL holds only 21% of the manganese ore it meets around 52% of the country's production demand and tries to achieve higher goals with this huge opportunity. This is a brief

history of MOIL. MOIL has a rich history having its journey started around 125 years ago from a single mine at Mansar in the district of Nagpur. From there on it became a CPSC in 1962 and got listed in 2010 December and now it has achieved the highest level of production since its inception. These are few details of our mines. We have 10 manganese mines in the state of Madhya Pradesh and Maharashtra. three are open cast mines and seven are underground mines. Q

MOIL LIMITED

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Manganese Ore (India) Limited

August 24, 2024

Page 6 of 19

We have a ferro manganese plant in the state of Madhya Pradesh in the district of Balaghat. 12,000 metric ton is the installed capacity. Similarly, we have the EMD plant which is the Electrolytic Manganese Dioxide which is used in alkaline batteries and lithium-ion batteries and dry cell batteries also. It has a plant capacity of 1500 metric ton. We have also installed renewable sources of energy which is around 20 megawatt in windmills and 10.5 megawatt in solar energy. We are contributing more than 56% of our energy requirement through renewable resources by which we are going zero carbon and contributing to the nation's reduction in carbon footprint also. These are our mines location. Mostly MOIL's mines are centrally located within 250 kilometres from Nagpur. MOIL's operate in the district of Balaghat, Bhandara and Nagpur. This is our capital structure. Government of India holds majority stake of MOIL's shares and apart from government of Maharashtra and government of Madhya Pradesh, the rest of shares are held by public at large and other institutions.

As we know and already got introduced to our Board of Directors, I want to reiterate our Board of Directors is led by Shri Ajit Kumar Saxena sir, our CMD sir, and comprises of experienced leaders and diverse expertise across industries, guiding MOIL with strategic vision and governance towards sustainable growth. Similarly, these are our independent directors. Our independent directors bring wealth of experience and contributes their valuable perspectives to MOIL strategic decisions. Let's go into the performance. As our CMD sir has already discussed about what we have achieved so far, but we are now in the phase where we will be achieving new heights. So in the first quarter, if you can see the green marks, we have already produced around 4.7 lakh tons of manganese ore in the first quarter itself. And in the first quarter, we have also sold 4.53 lakh tons of manganese ore. Similarly, in the area of ferromanganese, we have produced 2,948 metric ton of ferro manganese and 368 tons of EMD.

Exploitation is the prerequisite of any mining industry. So it is like a backbone to the mining industry. We have already doubled the last year, previous year exploration from 41,000 to 87,000 meters. And in the current year itself, we have already achieved 30,000 meters of exploration. Like exploration resource are the lifeline of any mining industry, we are making further efforts to convert these resources into reserves.

As you can see, we have already added significantly to our resources of our company. Last year itself, we have added 7.98 million tons of resources to the manganese ore. These are the key performance highlights for previous year. I have already gone through it. These are the first quarter's highlights. In the last 10 years, MOIL has given an outstanding return to its shareholders through consistently paying dividend. And in a phase manner, it has also bought back shares and also gave an outstanding return of 164%.

MOIL has consistently delivered strong returns to its shareholders, reflecting its commitment to value creation and financial growth. Being a corporate entity, it has also given back from where it has got so many

opportunities of growth. We promote skill development, community Q
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August 24, 202 4

Page 7 of 19

development, health, education, and also we protect our environment by planting trees and going green.

In the last three years, this is the movement of our share price. There is a significant potential of value unlocking in MOIL share from the current market position, which offers promising opportunities for growth and investment returns also. As you can see, it has already crossed the 400 mark. In the coming years, it may cross even more.

These are the visions envisaged by our steel policy and our management, which will be fulfilled in the coming years. As per national steel policy, India is targeted to produce around 300 million tons of steel by 2030. For producing that much of steel, around 11 million tons of manganese ore will be required. And MOIL has targeted around 3.5 million tons to be produced by 2030, increasing its market share from 20% to 32% by 2030.

We are focusing on enhancing our production and increasing by 20% in the current year from the last year. Apart from that, we also have a target of around 3.5 million tons with 3 million tons being produced from our current mines and 0.5 million from our other upcoming projects. These are the areas we are focusing on.

As I have already said, exploration is the lifeline and backbone to any mining industry. We are going for higher exploration, not only in the areas of our existing mines, but also outside our joint venture. We are proposing joint venture. We are taking up new shaft sinking projects, which will augment our operational efficiency.

We are enhancing our environmental clearance limits, which not only help in production, also achieving our targets. And we are also expanding in the other states also, the likes of Gujarat, Maharashtra, Madhya Pradesh, Chhattisgarh. All we are exploring for further point where we can achieve our production target of 3.5 million tons by 2030.

As I have already emphasized that exploration is the lifeline of any mining industry. These are the few details which are already achieved and what we have targeted in the current year. We are targeting around 1 lakh metres to be explored and further we will add to our reserves and resources in the current financial year.

Environmental clearance requirements are essential to MOIL 's expansion. It plans to scale up operations also. However, we are committed to navigating these regulations responsibly. By 2030, we are targeting environmental clearance for 5 million tons or 50 lakh tons, so that we can achieve our envisaged target of 3.5 million tons.

Our capital expenditure plan is strategically focused on expanding production capacity with modernization and mechanization of our mines to meet our growing demands and enhance our operational efficiency. In the last financial year, we have expensed more than our profit after tax in capital expenditure to improve our production capacity and also modernize our mines. These are the projects which are underway to enhance MOIL production capacity and operational efficiency. There are two high speed shaft sinking projects in Balaghat and Gumgaon mine. Q

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August 24, 202 4

Page 8 of 19

We have MOU with GMDC, that is a state PSE under the government of Gujarat. Also, we have exploration in the state of Madhya Pradesh in Chhindwada and MP and we have also started exploration in Chhattisgarh, Nilkanthpur block also. These are the few details in MOU with the state of Gujarat under GMDC. We are already in the process of signing up JV agreement, which will be completed shortly after state government's approval.

In the state of Madhya Pradesh, two areas have positive responses in Chhindwada and Balaghat and we are also in the process of finalizing our JV. In June

2024, we started the exploration operation in Nilkanthpur block of Chhattisgarh, and we are hopeful for finding positive results in those areas also. Thank you for your patience hearing.

Moderator: Thank you Ashwini. So now we will open the floor for question and answers. I am sure with the recent Supreme Court ruling a lot of you would have question on that. Please I would request you all to raise your hand and then call for the mic before asking for questions. So we will start. Sir please introduce yourself.

Ramesh Bhojwani: Ramesh Bhojwani from Mehta and Vakil . First and foremost, you have made an excellent presentation encapsulating the current state and going up to 2030, the vision is very heart warming and welcome. Sir one thought came to my mind in the vision 2030 you have given a conservative target of raising your production to 3.5 million ton, whereas one can foresee at least 5 million ton production coming from your side. Would like to have your thoughts on that?

Ajit Kumar Saxena: What we have committed is what is there in our control and right now we have leases, and we are planning to have ECs and then shafts in those mines. Definitely we can go to 5 million ton and further, but that all depends based on what kind of mines do we get from different - different new mines which we get. What we have committed is from existing mines only. So that is - for that we are sure that we are going to do that.

Ramesh Bhojwani: So that is an excellent remark, excellent comment you have made that it is only from the existing mines, but the new mines certainly can take you to 5 million ton .

Ajit Kumar Saxena: New mines would have certain shares in that, but not the mega share. But going to 5 million ton that definitely would require new mines.

Ramesh Bhojwani: And the second thought was, first and foremost, many congratulations for being the first CPSC to install windmills and progressively add solar power. Solar power has got the fancy and imagination of almost every company or private and public sector in India. I also see, Vision 2030, the doubling of this renewable energy from your side?

Ajit Kumar Saxena: We are working on that, but I would like to share that around 60% of our own consumption comes from renewable energy sources, from windmill as well as solar. So definitely be raising this.

Ramesh Bhojwani: That should go up to 100% and double by 2030 that was the thought.

Ajit Kumar Saxena: Sure. Q

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Manganese Ore (India) Limited

August 24, 2024

Page 9 of 19

Ramesh Bhojwani: Thank you and all the best.

Ajit Kumar Saxena: Thank you.

Digant Haria: Thank you. Hi, sir. It's a question from here. Sir, my name is Digant Haria from GreenEdge. Sir, we have been shareholders of MOIL for two years, so your great performance has benefited us, so thank you for that. And thanks to Antique also for timely writing the reports, arranging these events, it helps improve our understanding. So three questions from my side. Sir, in the Annual Report, you have increased the target from - since very long we used to write 30 lakh tons, now we have increased it to 35 lakh tons this year.

Sir, when we met you last time, you said that from our existing mines 21 lakh tons it will definitely reach. For more, we need these, you know, JVs with Chhattisgarh Madhya Pradesh and all these states. So this 35 lakh tons seems like what more will you need to do? Because in Annual Reports, you write that we are doing something next to existing mines. We have put all those shafts, increased the lift speed, operational efficiencies, but this 35 lakh tons seems ambitious. What will the company do?

And sir, I will tell you why I ask this. We were at 13 lakh tons in 2008. This number we crossed in 2023. So 15 years we took to cross that 13 lakh tons. Now we are talking of reaching like 35 lakh tons

in just 5 years from now. So if you can just explain own mines how much, JVs how much, new mines how much and why do we not go to the mineral rich states of Odisha and

Karnataka because in your own slide, we saw that 50% resources are in these two states whereas we are only going to states where the reserves are less. So that's the first from my side ?

Ajit Kumar Saxena: So about the breakup of 35 lakh tons. First of all, as we have mentioned in our presentation that exploration is a continuous activity and is backbone to any mining organization. So that is why last year when we said 21 lakh tons and this year if you have seen the presentation, the last year we have added around 7.98 lakh tons to our reserves. So this is a continuous activity, and we realize that how much magnesium we can get, or we will not get at all. So this is the result of continuous exploration.

Now coming to the breakup of 3.5 million tons, I will say that roughly what we have estimated now is 3 million tons from our own resources and 0.5 from other resources. But I feel that we have potential of reaching even 3.5 from existing mines. That's what I have said that for 3.5 we are sure and for the growth of maybe to another step 5 million tons we require more mines, and you never know. By that time we may be exploring more in the same area, and we will be getting more reserves and resources.

Digant Haria: Sir, second question is, how does the organization get so much energy like 15 years nothing happened, steel sector was down, we understand all that. But now in two years we are talking like as if we are running on the fourth gear now. So is this the government driving it or inside

the company the whole employee force is recharged? What has happened? Just very qualitative comments?

Ajit Kumar Saxena: I think it's a collective effort and very focused and synchronized effort of everyone. Maybe it was waiting for this time to happen. I can say only this. It's a collective effort and all forces are Q

MOIL LIMITED

(A Government of India Enterprise)

Manganese Ore (India) Limited

August 24, 2024

Page 10 of 19

working together. That is why we are achieving this, and we are confident that we will be crossing 2 million ton target this year.

Digant Haria: Sir, lastly on this Supreme Court verdict, we have seen that Jharkhand, Odisha, they have already, the states have started applying tax on whatever mining output is there. For us, Maharashtra and Madhya Pradesh are the two states which matter most. If they also decide to go that way, what happens to us?

Because we can't change our selling prices, they are determined globally. So that hit probably has to be absorbed by us. So any ballpark calculations you have done on what kind of hit can come or what can we do so that this does not happen?

Ajit Kumar Saxena: As of now, there is no major implication. I think DF (Director Finance) can tell better, but since we are working constantly on our cost, so we don't have much apprehension. And as of now, there is no major impact on past taxes. You would like to give some detail?

Digant Haria: No sir, but future, if we don't ask for the past...

Ajit Kumar Saxena: Future, we are working in a very focused manner on our cost. Of course, I cannot reveal the figures, but our cost is definitely a word benchmark.

Digant Haria: Okay sir, thank you.

Kunal: Hello sir, Kunal here from Centrum Broking. Thanks for the opportunity. So my question is in regard to the EC limit that we are looking to expand from currently 2.5 million ton to 5 million ton. So can you share any of this project timeline that we require the public hearing and everything all together. So what timeline that you have set, what has been achieved and for each milestone by how much time you are looking to get it done?

Ajit Kumar Saxena: Look, the beginning of this year that is 1st of April 2024, we had a

an EC of nearly 24.88 lakh tons. And for this year, financial year 2024 -2025, we have planned to apply for nearly 10 lakh tons. And out of that, 4.4 lakh ton has already been applied.

And remaining baseline study and other things are in progress. Some mining plans are being made. So we are sure that we will be applying another 10 lakh tons in this financial year. So that

will make it around 35. And next 10- 15 lakh tons we will be applying in the year 2025-2026.

For which detailing has to be done. But yes, we already have plans, and we have started working on that. So this is starting 25 lakh tons. This year application for 10 lakh tons. Next year application for another 15 lakh tons.

Kunal: Thank you, sir. Second question is in regard to the opening remark that you mentioned about enhancing global footprint as well. So any plans or outlook that something new for, I believe for everyone that may be with you, that you can share sir?

Ajit Kumar Saxena: We are working in different geographies and for different minerals also. With time we will come to know.

Kunal: Thank you very much. Q

MOIL LIMITED

(A Government of India Enterprise)

Manganese Ore (India) Limited

August 24, 2024

Page 11 of 19

Ajit Kumar Saxena: Thank you.

Vikas h: Hello sir, this is Vikash from Phillip Capital. Sir, just wanted to understand one thing. Since we have already an EC limit of closer to 2.5 million tons, what are the constraints which is stopping us to go to that figure in this year itself? Why are we taking a two -year timeline for that?

Ajit Kumar Saxena: I mean, we just clarify your question. I mean, do you expect that whatever EC we have we should be producing that much of amount?

Vikas h: No, India is importing 50% of the requirement. So there is a demand in India, right? So just wanted to understand the constraint which is stopping us to go to the full EC limit of mining capability.

Ajit Kumar Saxena: So it is a long process. I mean, you have to start from getting the land allocated for exploration.

You explore and having, I mean, there is a word, statistics that having successful exploration that is three out of thousand explorations lead to economically viable mine.

So you have to get the area, then you explore, then you start applying for EC, then you start planning various equipments and shafts, getting clearances. So it is a long drawn process. It just cannot be like you decide and you do it tomorrow.

Vikas h: So EC is there but our current capacities are lower, right?

Ajit Kumar Saxena: No, it is, we have to apply for EC also. Right now, we have ECs of only 24.88 lakh tons.

Vikas h: Okay, and what is the current capacity in terms of production capability?

Ajit Kumar Saxena: There is nothing called capacity because once you are in certain strata of mine, you may be getting 28%, you may be getting 42% that precision and accuracy is yet to be achieved, that you know from the very beginning that how much you are going to get at particular level. So

generally the score at present is around 77 %-78% we get from run -off mine. So if you get 24.88 lakh tons, you would be getting somewhere around 19.5 or 20 lakh tons of manganese ore.

Vikas h: Understood, sir. That's all.

Ajit Kumar Saxena: Thank you.

Kirtan Mehta: Good afternoon. Kirtan Mehta from BOB Capital Markets. You currently mentioned about that we have a production capacity of around 77%-78%. If we take it, it is closer to 2 million ton.

We are also looking at the production target of 2.49 million ton for the FY '25. So what would aid this production ramp up to 2.49 million ton during the year? And would you be able to also give a picture for the next two years as well?

Ajit Kumar Saxena: I think it is wrongly understood. This year we have capacities, that is environmental clearances of 24.88 lakh tons. Out of which, suppose you produce this much. So 78%-77% will be

clean

ore. That will be around 20 lakh tons. So that is what the plan for this year is. And this year we would be adding, we would be applying for another 10 lakh tons of environmental clearances.

That is easy. Q

MOIL LIMITED

(A Government of India Enterprise)

Manganese Ore (India) Limited

August 24, 2024

Page 12 of 19

Kirtan Mehta: So when we say the production target would be roughly around 14 %-15% growth this year over 1.5?

Ajit Kumar Saxena: Production target would be around 20 million ton plus. 20 lakh ton plus, sorry. That is 2 million ton. 20 lakh ton plus.

Kirtan Mehta: And from the 1-million -ton additional EC that we are targeting?

Ajit Kumar Saxena: That you will be getting throughout the year.

Kirtan Mehta: Throughout the year ?

Ajit Kumar Saxena: You may not be getting because there are so many clearances. There are certain places where certain committees have to clear things. Maybe committee is not there. When committee is going to meet, then your point will be there in their agenda. So it is not like switching on and switching off the fan.

Kirtan Mehta: Correct. I just wanted to understand, once you receive the EC, how many years would you take to reach that capacity? Because then you will have to plan the equipment and other things.

Ajit Kumar Saxena: Look, we have plan of producing say 35 lakh tons in the year 2029- 30. And right now we have produced 1.756. So you can say if we achieve a CAGR of 12% over next 5-6 years, we will be reaching there. And this year we have taken a target of more than 14 %-15%.

Kirtan Mehta: So it will be more or less a linear growth through the period?

Ajit Kumar Saxena: So 12% growth CAGR would take me there to 3.5 level. But last year it was 35%. I mean that is a historical thing. That cannot be repeated every year. So this year we have targeted of 15% plus. Accordingly, as we get EC, as our equipments get commissioned, in some year it may be less, in some year it may be more but definitely 12% CAGR we are targeting, so that we will be reaching 3.5 by the year 2029-30.

And we have clear cut plan as you have seen. We are planning to apply for the EC of 5 million tons by next year end. So even if it takes 1, 1.5, 2 years more, and if you calculate that 77 -78%

of 5 million tons, that comes to 3.5. So that EC we will be achieving much in advance to the year which we have committed for 3.5 million tons. So we are planning and of course there are different levels. One is equipment commissioning, another is getting clearances and then getting

all the contracts. So we are sure, I mean things are on right track.

Kirtan Mehta: Thank you for the details. Couple of more questions. One is about the two GVs that we are planning one with JMDC and second is MP. Would you be able to give us more details in terms

of what is the resource base that we have established there, what is the EC limit that we would be looking there, do we have some initial idea at this stage?

Ajit Kumar Saxena: In Gujarat, I can share that we have explored, and we have identified about 9.51 million tons of manganese ore. Now based on the joint venture signing and then getting clearances perhaps the starting year we can say another 2 lakh tons, maybe next year there is '25-'26 but potential is 9.5 Q

million tons. Madhya Pradesh exploration is still on. Chhattisgarh we have started exploration just in the month of June. But initial results are quite good.

Kirtan Mehta: One last question. You have shown the resource addition. Would you also share how have we added the reserves over the last couple of years? We have shown around 7.98 million of the resources. Correspondingly, what were our reserve addition figures for FY '24?

Ajit Kumar Saxena: Details, can you share?
M

M Abdulla : Last year we have added around 7 million tons of resources. This is by means of exploratory drilling. When you puncture the ore body and the geometrical figures are available regarding the depth, width and percentage of recovery of ore body, then we add the resources, and we convert resources into reserves. It is like that. It is a continuous process, perhaps.

Kirtan Mehta: Reserve addition number for FY '25, reserve addition that we would have done, we would have also sort of RP ratio, whether it increased, decreased during the year?

MM Abdulla : Actually, whatever reserves you have mined out, that we reduce from our resource base, then we convert the resources into reserves. It is like that.

Kirtan Mehta: Fine, sir. Thank you.

Hinal Kothari: Hinal Kothari here from Systematics. Sir, I wanted to know the grade-wise sales mix for FY '24 and historically, if it is possible?

Ajit Kumar Saxena: It is possible, but it is quite detailed. I mean, it is a full document. We can share it after the meeting.

Hinal Kothari: Okay.

Ajay Mehta: Good afternoon, sir. Ajay Mehta from Makrand Finance. Sir, two questions. I just wanted to clarify, whether this Ninth Bench Supreme Court decision, there is no past liabilities on that account?

Ajit Kumar Saxena: I think I have addressed it. There is not much implication of this decision.

Ajay Mehta: Quantify any figures, sir? Because somewhere I had seen in one of the Annual Reports, 2,500 contingent liability. Am I correct in that? INR 2,500 crores of various, various taxes.

Management: As far as the Supreme Court decision is concerned, it is about the power of the states. The royalties are taxed or not. Royalty is not a tax. And if the state governments are imposing certain taxes, those taxes have to be paid since 2005, in the next 12 years. So, in case of MOIL, there are no taxes with respect to state governments. So, there is no liability from the state government. So, this decision does not impact at all MOIL's operations. We do have the liability from the State Government Service Tax, but that is a different thing. That has already been disclosed in our contingent liability. So, as such, there is no liability. Q

MOIL LIMITED

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Manganese Ore (India) Limited
August 24, 2024

Ajay Mehta: Fair. Good answers. Sir, next one on this. Your quarter one results have been really very good, very encouraging. Congratulations on that. But can you give us a little idea how, if we break it up between volume and price, what has been the breakup and what would be your foreseeing for the next few quarters on this?

Ajit Kumar Saxena: Figures we already have shared about the volumes and volume was around 4.53 lakh ton.

Ajay Mehta: A percentage breakup between quarter four and quarter one, sir. If that is possible?

Ajit Kumar Saxena: That is definitely possible. I may not be having figures right now, but that is definitely possible. I think 4.53 lakh ton sale is there in Q1. And before that, it was 4.35. Q4 was 4.35 or 4.36. And right now it is...

Ajay Mehta: 8% up in volume.

Ajit Kumar Saxena: No, 8% is Y-o-Y. That is Q1 of FY '24. And Q1 of '24 with respect to Q1 of '25, there is a growth of 8%. Growth in Q1 of '25 with respect to Q4 of '24 is marginal.

Ajay Mehta: So the major difference, there is a small difference of INR 90 crores to INR 150 crores if I am not mistaken. So is the difference because of the price alone? I mean if there was a marginal difference in the volume?

Ajit Kumar Saxena: No, it is definitely prices as well as the grade. I mean what kind of grade is sold in that year, whether it was available or not. So lot many factors, but definitely prices have played. I think a rally of 3 to 3.5 weeks. That really made a difference. Yes, it was there.

Ajay Mehta: Sir, what do you feel of it going quarters ahead? Wou

Id the price be maintained in the coming future?

Ajit Kumar Saxena: Look, normally Q2 is a bit sluggish. And we expect that, still we expect around 2.5 to 3 lakh ton sale, 3 lakh ton plus sale even in Q2.

Ajay Mehta: Because whatever we could read, it meant that something in probably South America, some plant got disturbed and that is why the price shot up. And the U.S. were expecting some steel production.

Ajit Kumar Saxena: No, the plant which was, I mean the information which you have, whether there is a breakdown in some plant or some mine, that is still there and that will continue, I think as much we know that till end of this calendar year. But yes, that could be one factor, but there are many more other factors. I mean production of steel, demand of steel and further lack of producers.

Ajay Mehta: Sir, can we take it then that the next few quarters, the price would stay what it is today, averaging out 5% here and there?

Ajit Kumar Saxena: Prices what we have today, I mean in this Q2, I think most likely they will continue. But Q3 onwards, prices will go. And this is a regular pattern over years.

Ajay Mehta: Wonderful. Thank you so much. Q

MOIL LIMITED

(A Government of India Enterprise)

Manganese Ore (India) Limited

August 24, 2024

Page 15 of 19

Ajit Kumar Saxena: Thank you.

Analyst: Hi Sir. So, just one question. Since we are looking to double production from current to by FY '30, what kind of capex plans have we outlined for the next 4, 5 years?

Ajit Kumar Saxena: For last 2 years, capex is, or maybe 3 years, capex is more than our profit after tax. And even this year we have planned INR 328 crores, next year INR 340 crores. So we have, and if you understand the language of mining engineers, that is number of shafts to be added. So it is under process, but we have decided on 5 shafts to be installed in different mines. So capex is, there will be a gradual increase in capex.

Analyst: Hi Sir. This is Pavas from Birla Mutual Fund. So firstly on your quarterly results, if I look at a blended realisation, whatever volumes you have shared in the revenue number, there is roughly around 13%, 14% blended realisation growth. But if I look at your announcement over last 3 months, April, May, June, there was roughly around, on a blended basis, 30% increase in realisation, should be there.

So what is the gap between whatever you have announced, the hikes, and whatever you reported in your numbers? So there was one hike of 3%, 4%, then another 25%, 30%, and then another 30%. Throughout the quarter. So that culminates to roughly around 30% on a blended basis hike. And you reported 14% growth in realisation. So what is the gap, why the realisation was lower than expected?

Ajit Kumar Saxena: I couldn't get your question. Will you elaborate it please?

Analyst: Sir, during the, throughout the quarter in 1Q, in April, May and June, you announced certain price hikes across product price points. That culminates to 30% blended realisation. That should have been a growth in realisation for the quarter. But whatever you have reported, it seems it was only 14%, 15%. So is there some increased discounts, or is the mix?

Ajit Kumar Saxena: No, what you see, I mean, it is just one or two grades. But we have a lot many grades, so it is a mix of that. Which grade is having how much demand and how much could be dispatched. So the total net sales realisation is based on that. You monitor only one or two, 36% or 37% or 44%. But there are so many grades.

Analyst: Okay. And going forward, you have also announced certain kind of price corrections. So how this will trend in this 2Q?

Ajit Kumar Saxena: We do pricing only on a monthly basis. There is no price correction. We have to follow certain, we follow certain indicators, like stocks at different port, consumption, prices of ferro-alloys, steel market, and availability of ore. So

based on that, and the global prices, we fix our prices. It

is not correction. If you look at figures, I mean, there is a fluctuation across the globe.

Analyst: Sure. And secondly, on this employee cost, which is kind of, entire area was INR 550 crores, INR555 crores, which was lower than FY '23, how this number will trend, and how this number will trend with respect to your production growth? Q

MOIL LIMITED

(A Government of India Enterprise)

Manganese Ore (India) Limited

August 24, 2024

Page 16 of 19

Ajit Kumar Saxena: Like, Burton,

Analyst: No, not Burton. It's absolute number of INR550-odd crores for the full year as a whole?

Ajit Kumar Saxena: Absolute numbers will be fluctuating because there would be certain rise on account of your dearness allowance and increments of regular employees. There would be some retirements. So it is just not, if you want we can calculate...

Analyst: Because in FY '23 this number was higher.

Ajit Kumar Saxena: FY '23 this number was higher because in that particular year, we have revised the pay scales of employees. And it was with effect from 1-1-2020 or so. We had to pay arrears as well as new pay scales. And definitely after that, since arrear impact is not there, so it is coming down. Also we are focusing on cost. There is redeployment of manpower in effective areas with decreasing manpower. So definitely, overall cost is coming down.

Analyst: So when is the next big reset in terms of employee cost?

Ajit Kumar Saxena: That will be around 2027 or so.

Analyst: And any take on global markets, how the after South 32 disruption, how the market is performing in terms of supply and demand?

Ajit Kumar Saxena: They had an impact of around 3, 4 million ton. But if you look at production of manganese for last so many years globally, it is hovering around 59, 64 million ton. 3% of global steel production. So it is, I mean, not much of it.

Kunal: Hello. Kunal here again, sir. Sir, our country is opening up with critical minerals opportunity right now. And we are seeing lot of state-run government companies are also looking to participate in that opportunity and also looking to bid in overseas as well. In MOIL, how we see the opportunity for ourselves and aspiration that we have in India and overseas both together?

Ajit Kumar Saxena: As you have mentioned in the presentation, we are open to any geography and any mineral provided it is economically viable and viable proposition for the company. We are looking to different proposals and working on it. So as it comes, whether it is viable, then we will participate and then it comes to what we get. So we are very well into the group for going to new geographies and new minerals.

Kunal: Sir, any specific minerals that you are targeting right now that you are looking for in India and elsewhere?

Ajit Kumar Saxena: Not exactly. Of course, manganese is our core stream, but manganese involves underground as well as open cast mining. So as far as skills and other exposure is concerned, we are very well equipped. So it all depends on economic viability of the proposition. So no specific, but definitely we are looking for other minerals too. Q

MOIL LIMITED

(A Government of India Enterprise)

Manganese Ore (India) Limited

August 24, 2024

Page 17 of 19

Kunal: Sir, last question. Also there is lot of opportunity in ocean, seabed, mining as well, where huge manganese deposits are there. So any plans, any thoughts that you can share with us that MOIL can work on it?

Ajit Kumar Saxena: It is really premature about ocean, seabed, mining and who will get what rights and where exactly is the. Yes, it is a topic of importance and interest for last 1.5 years, 2 years. Deep ocean mining and yes, the best quality of manganese is lying there. But so far nothing commercially, no commercial proposal is available to any

one of us.

Kunal: Sir, any government's framework or initiatives has been undertaken that looks promising for mining in future, that you can share some light on it?

Ajit Kumar Saxena: Not specifically about manganese, but definitely it is part of steel policy. So government is working for becoming art in the world in that element too.

Kunal: Thank you so much, sir.

Analyst: Sir, can I ask a question? Sir, any target to reduce cost of production by percentage, any target in next 2, 3 years? How the cost of production reduces?

Ajit Kumar Saxena: Exactly, you cannot say target, but definitely as we are targeting a growth of around 14%, 15% every year, so you can presume that reduction in cost by 6%, 7% every, on year-to-year basis. Considering, because you do not know what will be the dearness allowance, what will be the, of course, the increment, but you do not know the dearness allowance.

So what is the area of focus? Area of focus is with the same manpower, if you can increase production. So if you take just same values, increase by 12%, 14%, 15%, you will get around 6%, 7% of reduction in production cost on year-to-year basis per ton.

Analyst: Sir, there is any basis that the employee cost goes up?

Ajit Kumar Saxena: Come again?

Analyst: If the profitability goes up, employee cost goes up?

Ajit Kumar Saxena: Not exactly, no linear relationship or predictable relationship.

Analyst: Thank you.

Moderator: Any other questions?

Subhabrata Mitra: Yes, hi, this is Subhabrata Mitra from Augmenta Research . So to augment your production capacity to 3.5 million ton, what is the targeted employee recruitment you need to do going forward?

Ajit Kumar Saxena: Look, as we have already said about, talked about the capex, we are, it is not only about installation equipment, equipping the commissioning of shafts, it also involves lot of mechanization. Because all those mines are 100 years old, and we are working also on changing Q

MOIL LIMITED

(A Government of India Enterprise)

Manganese Ore (India) Limited

August 24, 2024

Page 18 of 19

the way of how do we mine. Of course, it is an early stage, it is difficult to say, it is premature to say how exactly we are replacing, but definitely we are working on the more productive safer methods to dig out manganese so that we increase, we can have more mechanization and less requirement of manpower exactly.

Subhabrata Mitra: Okay, and my second question is that, out of this capex, whatever you are saying, what will be the modernization equipment and stripping cost, if you can give the bifurcation?

Ajit Kumar Saxena: Modernization?

Subhabrata Mitra: Equipment and the stripping cost that you start for new mines. You capitalize a certain portion of the stripping cost, right? So can you bifurcate that thing? In terms of...

Ajit Kumar Saxena: I think next financially we will be capitalizing two of our major projects and the other five which we are talking about is only at the stage of conceptualizing and locating and finding out the technology.

Subhabrata Mitra: So, whatever you are capitalizing next year, that would be, can you give an estimate of that stripping cost capitalization?

Management: That's basically the accounting aspect, stripping cost, so we need not disclose that separately, but as CMD sir has already said, next year, this year we are planning a target of INR 328 crores of capex, right? So, it includes everything.

Ajit Kumar Saxena: It will be capitalizing for two projects?

Management: Yes.

Subhabrata Mitra: So broadly, I wanted to know how much will it be for modernization and how much will it be for capitalization of the starting of the new mine of stripping cost?

Management: Basically, it depends, I think it's again a very internal assessment and the numbers, so we are doing both. We are doing, expanding in terms of increasing our shafts, major

capital projects and the modernizations. Can you elaborate your question more?

Subhabrata Mitra: Yes, so I am asking that you are doing a capex of INR 320 crores -INR330 crores, whatever, if you can subdivide that into the modernization portion capex and the stripping cost capex. Is it possible to keep that?

Ajit Kumar Saxena: No, no, it is just not possible because it all depends, it's in certain mines at certain levels you might be mechanizing the things and in the other level you are doing the things in the same old fashion. So, I mean, identifying that in the same mine, one level cost, another level cost, I mean that will be very difficult to share it. Definitely we will be working on it but that is very difficult to share. I think that, I mean, your question has addressed well. Thank you.

Digant Haria: Sir, two questions again. Sir, we import like 65% of manganese ore and I believe, in your presentation you showed 54 lakh tons. Sir, so what can we do to address this? Do they need a different grade which we don't produce or are we not doing enough marketing in, say, the Q

MOIL LIMITED

(A Government of India Enterprise)

Manganese Ore (India) Limited

August 24, 2024

Page 19 of 19

ferroalloy belt of Odisha where we can sell more? You know, what's your take on this? How much import substitution can we really do?

Ajit Kumar Saxena: Definitely, they also have certain points in importing. I mean, it is not exactly 100% grade. Few grades are definitely we are not producing. I mean, country is not having that. It is basically a mineral and definitely logistics-wise they have some advantages too when they are importing the material, especially the ferroalloy producers of Vizag and Durgapur.

More so, it is not only import of manganese ore but also the export of ferroalloys because whatever manganese-based ferroalloys are produced in country, nearly 50% of that is exported.

So, they definitely have advantage at times in importing, again based on what kind of prices country is offering, what kind of freight country is offering.

Digant Haria: Sir, you said that imports are competitive. Sir, imports may come from South Africa, Gabon, Australia. So, there

is a much longer distance whereas from Madhya Pradesh to Vizag is a much smaller distance. I just want to ask one more thing that what is our cost of production per kg and global average?

Ajit Kumar Saxena: You need to compare ocean freight and land freight. You will get the answer. I mean, there is a huge difference. In ocean freight and...

Digant Haria: Okay, sir, but just in terms of rupees per kg, like we are selling our products at INR8 to INR 11 per kg on an average. So, what would be our production cost on an average and how much is it dropping every year?

Ajit Kumar Saxena: Every year, you can say drop of 6 % to 7%.

Digant Haria: Sir, but that number per kg...

Ajit Kumar Saxena: I hope you understand.

Digant Haria: Thank you, sir.

Pallav Agarwal: Yes, I think, Sir, should we close it? Yes, okay. Any last questions, please? I think most of them -- so there was indeed a very insightful session, and I would like to thank the entire Investor fraternity for their time today and also express my gratitude to the CMD and the top management for making it today and giving us a picture of what the path ahead looks like for MOIL.

So also, this event would not have been successful without the efforts of our sales team from Antique corporate access, Bharati Ponda, the Company Secretary of MOIL, Mr. Neeraj Pandey, and our events manager, Mr. Sanjay Sahdev. So, I would also like to take some time out to thank all of them and as well as the hospitality team at Taj Land End for taking care of our needs. So now lunch will be served, and we can proceed for that. So, thank you all for coming. Q

MOIL LIMITED

(A Government of India Enterprise)

Call: Mar 2026

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CIN No: L99999MH1962GOI012398
CS/NSE -BSE/ 2025-26/445 Date : 20.03.2026

To,
The GM (Listing),
National Stock Exchange of India Ltd,
Exchange Plaza, Plot No.C -1, G Block,
Bandra Kurla Complex, Bandra (East),
Mumbai – 400053

To,
Listing Department
BSE Limited
Phiroze Jeejeebhoy Towers
Dalal Street
Mumbai - 400001
Sub: Investors' and Analysts' Meet - Transcript.

Dear Sir/Madam,

Further to our letter no. CS/NSE -BSE/2025 -26/444 dated 17th March, 2026 regarding “Inve stors' and Analysts' Meet ”, it is to inform that the tran script of the said Meet [dated 17.03.2026] has been uploaded on our website as detailed hereunder:

www.moil.nic.in Investor Relation Disclosures under Reg. 46 and 47 of SEBI LODR Regulation, 2015 Analysts / Institutional investor meet 17/03/2026 - Investors and Analysts Meet - 2026 (Transc ript)

Web link (Transcript) : https://moil.nic.in/userfiles/file/InvRel/Transcript_17032026.pdf

The transcript is enclosed as Annexure -I.

This is for your kind information and record please.

Thanking you,

Yours faithfully/ Hkonh;
For MOIL Limited/ d`Rks EkkW;Yk fYkfEkVsM

Neeraj Dutt Pandey/
(Ukhjt nRr ik.Ms;)
(Company Secretary & Compliance Officer)/
(dEiuh lfpOk lg vuqikyu vf/kdkjh)

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“MOIL Limited
Investors and Analysts Meet ”
March 17, 2026

MANAGEMENT : Mr. Rakesh Tumane – Director , Finance – MOIL Limited
Mr. M.M. Abdulla – Director , Prod .& Plng. –MOIL Limited
Ms. Rashmi Singh – Director Commercial – MOIL Limited
Mr. Ashwini Das – DGM Finance – MOIL Limited
Mr. Neeraj Dutt Pandey - Company Secretary - MOIL Limited

Co-presented by Anand Rathi – Institutional Equities

Anand Rathi : MOILs operations and growth outlook. Over the past few quarters, the company has navigated a dynamic operating environment while continuing to focus on its production journey. We look forward to discussing these developments with you in detail and addressing your questions. To take us through the company's performance and future roadmap, I would now like to invite the management team on stage.

MOIL Limited
March 17, 2026

Page 2 of 22

We are joined today by the senior leadership who will walk you through the key aspects of the business and share their perspective. Thank you and hope you find this session insightful. We would now like to invite Rakesh sir, Director Finance, Rashmi mam, Director Commercial, MM Abdulla sir, Director Production and Planning on the stage. After the initial presentation by the management, we shall open the floor for question and answer.

Anyone who wishes to ask a question, please raise your hand and we shall pass the mic around. Request the participants to state their name and firm's name before asking the question. If you wish to ask a follow-up question, we would request you to please state your name and firm's name again, as the session is getting recorded. We would now like to invite Mr. Ashwini, DGM Finance MOIL for the presentation on the company.

Ashwini Das: Good morning, everyone. I want to extend my warm welcome to all of you for taking your time and gracing us on the occasion. Your presence is a testament to your interest and confidence in our company. Over the past one year, MOIL has made significant strides in the areas of production, sales, environmental clearance, and all capex. We are excited to share with you not only what we have accomplished so far, but also the strategic initiatives and what we are pursuing to drive our future. In today's presentation, we will cover our current performance, growth strategy, and exciting developments on the horizon. But more than that, we aim to provide you a clear understanding of how we intend to create the sustainable growth and value to our company. So be invested.

MOIL has a rich history of more than 125 years. It started in the year 1899 as Central Prospecting Syndicate. Later, it was converted into a public company as CPMO. In 1962, Government of India took over from CPMO and ..

Rakesh Tumane: One minute. A very good morning to all of you. I am seeing a lot of old faces. We have been meeting investors and analysts on a continuous basis for the last four, five years. So I see many of the familiar faces. But still, there are a lot of faces which are new. And this manganese industry, that is the manganese mining, is a completely unknown creature. Many of the people do not know what is manganese mining.

In fact, when I joined MOIL, somebody said that you are joining Manganese Oil India Limited. So that is the kind of awareness that was there. Now the awareness is much better about the MOIL. And I am sure that we are covering this presentation in a little detail so that we are giving a history so that the people who have joined for the first time and who are new, they get an idea about the company. So please bear with us, those who already know about it. Yes, thank you.

Ashwini Das: So in 1962, Government of India took over from CPMO and acquired 51% stake. In 1991, MOIL

set up the first EMD plant in India. In 1998, MOIL set up its Ferro Manganese plant. In 2010, MOIL listed in NSE and BSE. In 2014, MOIL was upgraded to a public sector Schedule A CPSE. In 2025, MOIL has achieved its highest ever production and sale.

MOIL is the largest producer of manganese ore in India. It contributes around 50% of the domestic production of manganese ore. MOIL is the first CPSE who have set up the windmill

MOIL Limited
March 17, 2026

Page 3 of 22

in India and also the only company to produce EMD which is used in dry cell batteries. Around 43% of its energy consumption is sourced from renewable energy.

I will tell a brief about what is manganese ore and how it is used in the industry. Manganese ore has several important uses, primarily in the steel and industrial sector. In steel production, it is used as a deoxidizing agent for removal of oxygen and sulfur impurities, improving the steel durability and strength. Manganese is also add

ed to steel alloys to enhance hardness, tensile strength, and resistance to wear and tear.

Manganese is used in cathodes of lithium-ion batteries, which are commonly found in EVs and portable electronics. Manganese dioxide is a key component in production of alkaline batteries. Manganese ore compounds are used in paints, ceramics, and micronutrients in fertilizers. Since manganese is a critical component in steel production, the demand for steel directly affects the manganese ore prices. Higher the steel production leads to the increased demand and potentially higher prices.

First of all, explaining this slide, I will tell you something about reserves and resources.

Resources are the identified mineral occurrence in reasonable prospects for extraction, and reserves are economically viable portions of those resources that can be extracted. Usually, exploration of these reserves and resources forms the basis of any mining industry. As per the last published data, MOIL holds around 20% of the India's manganese resources, through which it meets the company's 50% demand.

MOIL has 10 mines: three opencast mines and seven underground mines, which are operated in the state of Madhya Pradesh and Maharashtra. In the Balaghat District, and in Maharashtra, we have Bhandara District and Nagpur District. Mostly its production comes from underground mines, around 70% of its production.

MOIL's authorized capital is of INR300 crores, out of which paid-up capital is of INR203.48 crores. Government of India holds the majority stake apart from Government of Maharashtra, which holds 5.96%, and Government of Madhya Pradesh 5.35%. The rest of the shares is held by public at large and financial institutions.

I will brief you about manganese ore global market scenario. The global market is competitive with significant players from countries like South Africa, Central Africa, Australia, China. India contributes only 5% of the global manganese ore production. And MOIL primarily operates and focus within India. Our company contributes to explore ways to enhance its production through various possible exploration of reserves and resources.

Around 5.5 million tons of manganese ore is imported on an average from the data of last five years. And MOIL contributes around 1.4 million tons of manganese ore. However, our last year's production was around 1.8 million tons. MOIL contributes around 50% of the market share and it holds around 18% market share.

Our Board of Directors comprises of experienced leaders with diverse expertise across industries, guiding MOIL with strategic vision and strong governance to drive sustainable

MOIL Limited
March 17, 2026

Page 4 of 22

growth. Our Independent Directors bring wealth of experience, ensuring robust governance, contributing value perspective to MOIL strategic decisions.

Now let's discuss about our performance. In the year '24-'25, MOIL has achieved its highest ever production of 1.8 million tons, which is around 18.03 lakh tons. In the previous year also, it has achieved around 1.8 million tons.

Similarly, in the field of sales, MOIL has achieved its highest ever sale of 1.6 million tons, which is roughly around 15.88 lakh tons. Our total income for the financial year '24-'25 was INR1,696 crores, and it is the highest ever revenue achieved by MOIL till its inception. These are the last five years' physical performances.

As you can see, MOIL has been continuously improving its performance through various exploration of reserves and resources, improving its capex, and investing in production activities. MOIL has also two other segments: EMD, that is Electrolytic Manganese Dioxide,

and ferro manganese. MOIL has also striving to achieve its growth in those fields also. This is our nine months' performance. Up to nine months of financial year '25-'26, we have achieved 1.4 million tons, that is 14.21 lakh

tons, as compared to previous year 13.31 lakh tons.

We have also achieved 10.84 lakh tons of sale of manganese ore against 11.40 lakh tons of manganese ore.

This is our financial performance. As we can see that we have a stable operating margin during the last five years. And due to the strong performance and efficient operation and strong demand, which are supported in maintaining this stable margin.

This is the financial performance of the nine-month period. For the financial year '25-'26, MOIL has achieved total revenue from operation of INR1,056 crores against INR1,152 crores. And total revenue MOIL has achieved around INR1,126 crores against INR1,238 crores. The profit before tax is around INR223 crores against INR362 crores, and profit after tax is INR175 crores against INR266 crores.

This is basically due to fall in the NSR, which is not controlled by MOIL. It is usually controlled by the demand of steel and LME and all those factors which decides the net sales realization. Also, we have declared two interim dividends during the financial year. First interim dividend was of INR1.80 and second interim dividend was of INR3.53. This is the quarter-wise performance.

MOIL believes in strong shareholder value creation. Its average return on equity is around 161% over the last 10 years, and it demonstrates our commitment to our shareholders' value creation. We are focusing on various strategic areas for improving our performance. First is beneficiation of our low-grade products to enhance its value so that its realization can be improved. Second is agglomeration or briquetting, which is to promote our low-grade, again low-grade fines and low-grade materials to a stable grade so that the realization can be improved. Second is we are exploring our footprint in the overseas market so that we can unlock our export possibilities.

MOIL Limited

March 17, 2026

Page 5 of 22

As per National Steel Policy 2017, by 2030, total steel production is envisaged around 300 million tons. To achieve that 300 million tons of steel production, around 11 million tons of manganese ore is required. MOIL is committed to produce around 3.5 million tons of those manganese ore by 2030. MOIL is increasing its market share from 20% to around 32% by 2030. This is our expected growth by 2030.

We are focusing on higher exploration to add reserves and resources, taking up new shaft projects for deepening into the underground mines. We are also focusing on enhancing our EC limits so that our there will be no restriction on production of manganese ore. We are also increasing our production capacity by improving our infrastructure. Also, we are planning to expand our business in other states through joint ventures and MOUs.

During '24-'25, we have explored around 1,07,000 meters of reserves and resources, thereby adding around 16.07 million tons in FY '24-'25. This is our EC expansion projections. At present, we have around 36.33 lakh tons of EC limit, and we are expected to increase it up to 50 lakh tons, that is around 5 million tons, to achieve that 3.5 million tons of manganese ore production. These are our upcoming shaft sinking projects. These are the awarded cost of the five shaft sinking projects, out of which three are in Dongri Buzurg mine, which is our biggest opencast mine, and two are in Kandri mine and Chikla mine. One is in Bhandara District, another is in Nagpur District.

Total of around INR664 crores of investment is put into the shaft sinking projects so that our infrastructure can be improved and production targets can be achieved in the future. And this is the proposed years of completion by which the projects are expected to be completed.

In the greenfield area, we have already in an advanced stage in two of our projects. One is GMDC, another is Bhudkum block of Bhudkum and Selva block of Balaghat, Madhya Pradesh. Another

we have also in exploration in the area of Balrampur in Chhattisgarh, Nilkanthpur and Balrampur in Chhattisgarh.

In the year '24-'25, MOIL achieved its highest ever capex investment of INR321.94 crores, roughly around INR322 crores, and is expected to increase year-wise. In the current year, we have envisaged around INR325 crores of capex investment for capacity enhancement, modernization, and mechanization of our mines.

In the GMDC project, we are already in an advanced stage, we have already received the approval of DIPAM and NITI Aayog for JV formation. And Government of Gujarat has already forwarded its file for allocating that lease area in favor of GMDC so that JV agreement can be initiated.

In the state of Madhya Pradesh, MOIL has already explored around 300 hectares of -- MOIL has got around 300 hectares of land for exploration, and it has completed its exploration of 16,360 meters in Chhindwara and 55,270 meters in Balaghat District. Out of which, MOIL has successfully established ore bodies in Bhudkum block and Selva block, which are in Chhindwara and Balaghat District.

MOIL Limited

March 17, 2026

Page 6 of 22

And MOIL has already signed a draft JV agreement with Government of Maharashtra and Madhya Pradesh Steel Mining Corporation Limited in 2024 in MP Mining Conclave in the presence of Honorable Chief Minister of Madhya Pradesh. And MOIL has also received its approval from DIPAM and NITI Aayog for formation of the JVC. And the JVC is already in the process for approval and all those things.

In Nilkanthpur block, MOIL has already taken up exploration and MOIL has already completed around 11,628 meters of core drilling. And some boreholes have also yielded positive results, but due to some local issues, currently the drilling is suspended. Thank you.

Moderator: Anyone who wishes to ask a question, please let us know, we will pass the mic around. Thank you. Just please state your name and your firm's name.

Arijit: Hello. Hi, sir. This is Arijit from Kotak. If you can brief about Balaghat mine, whether we reached the -- the high-speed shaft in Balaghat mine, whether we reached the ore body, when are we planning for commissioning? Some bit of details. Thanks.

M.M. Abdulla: The present working level is at 450 meters around, which we are mining at present. And this high-speed shaft is going up to 650 meters. And the ore body is proved up to 1,000 meters. That is the geological condition of that ore body. And the high-speed shaft got delayed because of this visa issues related to Chinese and COVID, etcetera. And we are at the final stages of completion. And we expect by next financial year, it will be operational. Anything more, anything more you want to listen?

Arijit: Yeah, by next financial year means which quarter?

M.M. Abdulla: Actually, the winding installations are going on. The technical work which is supposed to be done by the Chinese has already been completed, the equipping of the shaft sinking. Sinking is already completed, equipping is also completed, and the winders' installation is going on. So I expect by it will take another six months in the next financial year to make it operational.

Arijit: Sir, November when we last met, that time we were guiding that in two months the ore body will be reaching and in three months it will be operational. So in March, another six months, why this delay?

M.M. Abdulla: Ore body is already there. I am not able to get your question. There is ore body already there up to 1,000 meters. Actually, ore body is running and ore body -- in the center of the ore body, we are sinking the shaft. There is no issue of ore body related with the sinking of the shaft. Okay.

Rakesh Tumane: I think last time when we met, hello, are you able to hear me?

Arijit: Yes, sir.

Rakesh Tumane: I think you are confusing with the Gumgaon project. When we s

aid that in three months we will

be doing, that was the Gumgaon project. We are running two projects at the moment. See what happens when the things go bad, they go bad. Whatever you do, they do not get resolved. So we started these -- we have at the moment, we are having two running projects. One is the Balaghat

MOIL Limited

March 17, 2026

Page 7 of 22

project, which is the Balaghat high-speed shaft sinking projects, and second is at Gumgaon. So these are two different mines.

At Balaghat, we are we have the shaft is up to 650 meters, and in Gumgaon, the shaft is up to 330 meters, 300 meters something. So these are two different projects. And in Gumgaon, we have already commissioned the winder system there. The mine winding system has already been commissioned, and what we would have told last in November was about the Gumgaon mine, in three months we will be doing. That is right? Yeah.

And this Balaghat mine is a different mine. Now as Abdulla sahab is telling, see ore body is already there, okay. So there is no question of whether the ore is not there. The ore body is there. So we are reaching the ore body, and because in the last few things require a little bit of more detailed working, so in a six months' time we will be ...

Arijit: Sir, I'm talking about reaching the ore body. Did we reach the ore body in the shaft? That's what I'm asking.

M.M. Abdulla: I am not able to get your question actually. Actually, the ore body is actually it is having a strike

length of some 1.5 kilometers, okay. It is in the property. And we sink the shaft in the generally in the central portion of the ore body, so that the roadways can be made in both the directions, both north and south directions. For that purpose, ore body is there already up to 650 meters.

Rakesh Tumane : Wait a minute. What happens, again I'll explain you the -- how the shaft sinking is done. As Abdulla sahab said, first we sink a shaft, which is nothing but a hole, okay. It's a lift, right. A lift going in opposite direction. Lift goes upwards, and this lift is going downwards, okay. So you sink a hole for a lift, okay. So there is a shaft equipping is there, which is basically the lift for -- to operate the lift you require certain the system there, girders, etcetera, lines, etcetera, right, okay. So that is called as a shaft sinking. So shaft sinking is over, okay.

Lift -- the hole for the lift is done, the shaft there's a lift -- to operate the lift -- lift is operating at both the places now. The lift is operating also at Balaghat and also at the Gumgaon. But when you operate the lift, there is a one lift in the same lift, there is a one portion is for the mine winding to take the men and material and second is for the ore, okay. So there are two different systems, two different winding systems are there, okay, hoisting systems are there.

So in Gumgaon, we have already done the mine winding system, okay. Material winding we are in the process of doing it, okay. In Gumgaon, that is yet to be done. Balaghat, that is yet to be done, okay. We will be doing that shortly. And from when we do a hole, for example, lift, from the lift you go to the different flats, right. So different flats you can call as the ore, okay. So you do a development to the ore body. So that development to the ore body is also going on, okay. So that is we are reaching the ore now. So when we reach there, we will start extracting the ore, okay.

Arijit: Understood. In Balaghat, current production rate is 6.5 lakh tons, right?

M.M. Abdulla : 6.5 lakh, no. It is around 3.5 lakh tons, yes. EC is for 6.5.

MOIL Limited

March 17, 2026

Page 8 of 22

Arijit: And after coming after we get the shaft done, the high-speed shaft, this 3.5 will be increased to what level?

M.M. Abdulla : The highest possible that will be around 8 lakh tons.

Arijit: 8 lakh tons.

And the timeline?

M.M. Abdulla : That will be the highest production capacity of that mine, may take around five to six years to get that stage.

Arijit: So after coming the -- after the shaft is commissioning, I believe the EC we are targeting this 6.5 to increase to 13, right sir?

M.M. Abdulla : Yes.

Arijit: So after the shaft is commissioned, what is the timeline that you are looking for, for the ramp-up? In year one, 3.5 will become how much before it reach the 8.5 as you were saying?

Rakesh Tumane : See, we already have an internal plan for that, okay. See, we already have an internal plan for that, but to tell that how much exactly to promise that would be a difficult to tell. But we have an internal plan for that, right. So as Abdulla sahab said, that is the 8 lakh tons per year that will be reaching. But the capacity as you see, what happens, it is something like that success brings success, okay. Nothing succeeds like success.

Once you start doing, then the things become easier and the production rate increases. In the beginning, everything is difficult until it then afterwards it becomes easy. The same the EDM works here also. Once we reach the ore body, it starts working, the mining become would become easier. Because now we will be working with the bigger system. At the moment a t generally in MOIL, our systems are basically the approach to the haulage road, etcetera, they are 2.5 meters into 2.5 meters, 3 meters something.

This would be 4.5 meters into 4 meters or 5 meters something. So the ore body that the haulage road itself, the working system itself would become bigger. So there would be a bigger possibility of extracting the ore. So it will be definitely increasing.

Arijit: Actually, you have already given a guidance, I just wanted to confirm that. FY '27, the target was INR5.5 lakhs, and FY '26, it was INR4 lakhs. So certainly FY '26, we are not reaching the INR4 lakhs, I believe so because it's not operational. But FY '27, what can we expect or rather FY '28 now, can we expect crossing INR5 lakhs in FY '28 itself?

Rakesh Tumane: See, in the next year our target is INR25 lakhs for the whole of MOIL.

Arijit: I'm talking about Balaghat ?

Rakesh Tumane: Yeah, Balaghat, then in INR25 lakhs or INR4 lakhs is the production from Balaghat .

Arijit: Understood. Thank you, sir.

MOIL Limited

March 17, 2026

Page 9 of 22

Manav: Yeah. Hi. Good afternoon and thank you for the opportunity. This is Manav from Yes Securities. So first question, I wanted to ask basically if we look over the last few quarters, there's a disconnect between the production and the sales volumes. We have done a production of roughly INR1.4 million and only INR1 million in sales. So could you just, you know, help me in understanding why the production is not translating into the sales? What are the factors behind the same?

Rashmi Singh: Good afternoon, Manav. See, there is no disconnect as you said, you know. Production and sales are completely aligned as far as MOIL is concerned. First, let me just explain you the market space. Market is divided into three zones basically. One is Vizag, one is Durgapur or Eastern zone we say that, and the main zone is Central zone. Not the main zone, they are if you see the volumes, they are almost equally divided, 3 million, 3 million, 3 million.

And we are sitting in the center. So in fact, we are not even able to reach Vizag and Durgapur because there is enough demand in Central region. As I said, it's about 2.8 million tons, and as you are aware, our production is about say 1.8 million. Out of that 1.8, about 1.3 is prime grade basically and balance about 5 lakh tons is lower grades.

So you must be aware that the average grade required to make ferroalloys is about 33 to 37 depending on what you are making, whether it is silicomanganese or ferromanganese. So and our where I say our prime

grades, what I mean is close to average grade. So for that, we are not even able to take care of the requirement of the Central region, which is very close to us and which is not accessible for the imported ore.

So if these people want to use the imported ore, they have to shell out at least INR1500 per ton extra in logistic cost. So we are very, very competitive in the Central region, and there is space to grow by another 1.5 million tons within the Central region for MOIL. So what I see is that even next three, four years' production, we will be we won't need to go to Vizag or Calcutta, that that zone.

We are very comfortable in taking care of the Central region requirement. So what you are pointing out at is the gap between that 1.8 and probably 1.6. The gap is not more than 2 lakh tons. Over a period of time, it depends, you know, on the stage of development of a mine. There are certain times when proportion of lower grades goes up. So in past few months, only in past few months, production of lower grades has component has slightly gone up.

And we have been very quick to find markets for those lower grades and sell additional, I think this year the growth is about 50% in case of the lowest grade, which is mainly used for blending. So these lower grades are basically used for blending with high grades. As you are aware, lot of high grade is being imported. So for using those high grade, customers need low grades to blend. So in the country, you must be aware there are very many small, small mines, about 8 to 10 small mines which are scattered all over India. So even in Vizag and Eastern region also, there will be some local mines, which are obviously not producing any average grade. They are producing only low grades, even below 20%. So initially, obviously the imported ore for the users will try to use the locally available ore because of the logistic cost.

MOIL Limited

March 17, 2026

Page 10 of 22

So they prefer to buy from the local miners. But once that material is consumed, then of course MOIL is also able to capture those markets. So if you see in last three years, I have the data for last three years, and the growth every year has been almost 50% in sale of low grades. So we have markets for that. But largely these materials should be used for beneficiation because as it is, it is difficult to consume these materials.

And but for beneficiation, when we want somebody to put up a plant for beneficiation, obviously the party would ask us to commit larger resources on a continuous basis. If we are able to supply let's say about 3 lakh tons per annum for next let's say three years, four years, then a party would be very much willing to set up a plant closer to our mines and use our material.

So they want a commitment for resource. That we didn't have because our component of low grade was not that much. We were not in a position to commit any big volumes of low grade. Which probably now in future going forward, because we are as such planning to ramp up our production and mechanization is increasing. So with mechanization, obviously, you know, lot of contamination takes place, at least to some extent.

So we are now probably thinking of committing this bulk volume to somebody who is interested to set up a plant closer to our mines. We are moving in that direction. So that you can say waste to wealth. So we are moving in that direction and we are confident of having a MOU shortly whereby even these low-grade materials can be sold in the market. But let me tell you, the value of these grades is much less.

So it is nothing to worry about even if we are suppose holding, you know, some 5 lakh tons of

low grades. It's there's nothing to worry about because that as once we are able to commit that kind of resource on a regular basis, there is every likelihood that some partner will be there for beneficiation. So that is the gap

you're talking about. But as I said that once we reach newer ore bodies, production of ferro grade also jumps substantially.

So production of ferro grade is also increasing and so is the component of low grade in between has gone up, but going forward, ferro grade will continue to increase and for which there is an enough market to expand.

Manav: Okay. Yeah, thank you. Just, you know, one follow-up on the same. Would you be able to quantify what your high-grade and low-grade inventory levels would be as of the last quarter?

Rashmi Singh: In high grades, we don't have any inventory because whatever is produced is already covered by orders. So it gets produced, gets tested, and gets dispatched. That is the cycle, you know. So monthly we produce about 80,000 tons of high grade. And in fact, 30% is also a high grade, that's also considered average grade. That is another 1.5 lakh tons. So about 1.5 lakh tons annually.

So another 10,000. So 90,000, 95,000 is high grade and balance is about less than let's say 30% is we generate fines also. That is not low grade or high grade, that is fine as such in any grade. So that has a ready market for itself. That's about 3.5 lakh per annum, 3 to 4 lakh tons per annum. So this low grade what I was talking about is another 5 lakh annually.

MOIL Limited

March 17, 2026

Page 11 of 22

Manav: Okay. So basically in a gist, if I had to understand, the production and the sales will start normalizing only once we get a, you know, partner where we are able to allot those volumes to?

Rashmi Singh: No, I'm not saying that. What I was saying that was that we get a partner only if we are able to commit a large resource, low-grade resource to them. So we think that we are now in a position probably, we are still evaluating, we have interested parties, but we are still evaluating whether we are in a position to commit. Because, you know, you must be aware that China and Indonesia are importing lot of low-grade material.

In fact, government had appointed MOIL as the state trading enterprise for all exports of manganese ore from the country. So that we were in fact in February 2024, this order came out, and from June last year, we started exporting. So low grade ore whatever is available near the ports, most of the miners are interested to export because as I said demand locally is only for blending which is not much. So we have already exported three shipments. So once that material moves out of the country, that makes room for our material to get consumed as such for blending. So as I said our sales are also increasing in 20% and 25% low grade. Sales are increasing every year by 50%. Okay so this year the sales are likely to be around 5 lakh tons which was earlier say 3 lakh, before that it was only 1.5 lakh. So every year the sales are also jumping. And export markets have also opened up. After exporting as STE, we are now very comfortable to export our own ore also.

We have recently booked in fact one parcel of 60,000 tons of low grade of our own ore for exports. So it depends whatever wherever we find value we will adopt that commercial practice. We can sell in domestic market if we get a good price, we can export because there's a regular demand for these materials and for India 2 lakh, 3 lakh tons may be a big quantity, but for export market it's a very small quantity. Three-four shipments annually or even in 6 months is not a very big quantity for exports.

So we will decide what to do, we haven't taken a call yet. But -- and we are also as it was shown in the presentation also, this year the one of the major focus areas is our own beneficiation. So we are mulling with that idea also. We may set up beneficiation units within our mines so that we don't have to sell because we want to add value.

We have actually the Government allows us to sell above 10%, but currently we are selling only above 20%.

So we have stocks of 10 to 20 also. So we are mulling over we'll decide whether to have beneficiation unit within our plant. But let me tell you we want to convert this waste to wealth and this year the focus will be on beneficiation. So we'll decide whether we'll beneficiate ourselves or we'll commit to a third-party if we have that kind of resource.

Manav: Okay. Yeah, thank you. Ma'am, the second question is over the last few years we have been guiding that import substitution is a very good opportunity for MOIL. And you just now mentioned that you're basically catering to the central market where the imports usually don't come about. So how should one read that story for MOIL?

Rashmi Singh: See, import substitution, if we don't supply in central region, right, where we have a strong presence because our NSR is highest there, if we don't supply to that region, then these people

MOIL Limited

March 17, 2026

Page 12 of 22

will also have to use imported material. Isn't it? So import substitution takes place when you increase your overall volume. It doesn't matter whether you sell it in central or eastern. If I can sell my material in central region, I would like to get the highest value for that, right? So import substitution happens when you increase your production of saleable grades. And we are continuously doing that.

Manav : Okay . Sure. Ma'am just one last question , just wanted to have some clarity on with the volume visibility over the next couple of years. You just mentioned that 25 lakh tons is what we are targeting for FY '27. Your presentation states a similar number for this particular year that is roughly 23.6 lakhs for FY '26, which I believe is going to be a big, big challenge considering the first 9 months was only 1.4. So are there any internal targets that we have to reach that 35 lakh production by 2030 ? And if you could just provide some color on the same?

Rakesh Tumane: This year target we had revised to 23.5 lakhs not 25, okay . And we have come and we'll not be able to reach 23.5 lakhs this year. It will be lesser than that, it would be somewhere between 19 to 20, okay . That would be our production this year. But definitely next year's target is 25 lakhs and we are working on that.

As we have discussed very in detail about our two projects, okay? So these two projects , basically we were expecting to start early , but these projects have not started as per their schedule. So there's a little delay and that's why this 23.5 lakhs could not be achieved , okay . So definitely , but these projects would be commissioned in this year and the next year and 25 lakhs will be achieved.

M.M. Abdullah: In addition to that, we are going for mechanization s also. Actually basically underground manganese mining generally comprises of more manual efforts. We are converting these manual mining into semi-mechanized and from semi -mechanized to mechanized state also.

We are deploying some LHDs, SDL machines in underground and we are also thinking of changing our method of mining from conventional cut and fill to long hole stoping method also that experiments are also going on. So with these changes, we hope that we will achieve our targets in the coming years.

Manav : Sure. So, the production and sales guidance will go hand in hand is going to be a fair assumption over the course of the next?

M.M. Abdullah: Yes definitely , definitely.

Manav : Yeah , sure. Thank you. Thank you so much.

Chirag : Hello. Yeah , hi. This is Chirag from Neo Asset Management. So wanted to understand w

hat is

your mining cost per ton currently and what will be the roadmap for the, let's say, next 3, 4 years.

It is ex royalty?

Rakesh Tumane: Hello. This figure actually earlier we never used to talk about , but now it has become one of our parameters in our MOU . You understand MOU parameters? Basically we sign a memorandum

MOIL Limited

March 17, 2026

Page 13 of 22

of understanding with the administrative ministry and it becomes our performance parameter for the whole company.

So the cost of production is one of that parameter . And last year, that is '24-'25 our cost of production was around , that is for manganese ore, was at the fact -- because our cost of production the factory gate was around INR5,500 per ton and this year would be around 53 something so there will be reduction in the cost of production.

And this cost of production is one of the most competitive . In fact, if you compare with any company around the world this is the Q1 kind of the cost of production. It is very competitive and it's in the one of the best, I would say.

Chirag : So this is ex royalty right?

Rakesh Tumane: Yeah , yeah , yeah.

Chirag : And once you reach 35 lakh ton this will remain at INR5,500 or it will be lesser than that?

Rakesh Tumane: It would be going down because the reasons being at the moment some 5 years back , our MOIL's total employee number was around 6,000 something. Today our number is around 5,200. So the number of people are going -- the retiring is going up, okay and number of people are going down , basically the working people. And this will continue , happening continue.

And the way we are operating our mines is that we would be doing more of outsourcing, okay.

Yeah , we'll be doing more of outsourcing . So the permanent employee would be going lesser and lesser, it would be outsourced model. And we are, as Abdullah saab said, we'll be doing more and more of mechanization. Earlier as we were doing semi-mechanized mines , that is

manual mines more hands were required.

As we move to mechanization lesser hands would be required. So the mining itself would become more productive. You'd be requiring to do the same amount of mining you'll require lesser people. And with mechanization you would be doing more mining, okay, with a lesser hand. And then we are also, Abdullah saab said, we are changing the -- our method of mining. At the moment our method of mining is conventional cut and fill method which is very laborious that is very labor oriented and inefficient, okay. And now we want to go for a long hole open stoping which is very, very productive. It is 5x to 6x or 10x more productive. So over a period of time our production would increase with a lesser manpower. So the cost of production will go down because at the moment the biggest portion of our cost of production is our manpower, which is almost around 48% something.

Chirag : And the current production, I mean, in the mines, do you have -- you do it on completely on your own or is it through MDOs? And if it's through MDOs, then what is your share in that?

And once you reach, let's say, 27 and 35 lakh tons, then how much will be done through MDOs?

Rakesh Tumane: At the moment we are not using any MDOs, okay, because these are all very traditional mines, okay we have not started till now any new mines. The old mines are continuing, okay. So MDOs

MOIL Limited

March 17, 2026

Page 14 of 22

are usually come into picture when you have to restart the mine, okay from the beginning. So we don't have any of those mines.

All our mines are old mines and we are continuing with that. So we don't have MDOs at the moment.

But we do mining in both ways. We have our internal people also, we have outsource also. So Abdullah saab can...

M.M. Abdullah: Actually the core activity is being done by the company people for more expertise for doing the mining. And the ancillary operations like loading of rock and doing some supporting works these things are being done contractually.

Chirag: And once you reach let's say 35 lakh tons, how much will be, used captively for making ferroalloys and how much will be sold outside? And what is your cost of manufacturing the ferroalloys?

Rakesh Tumane: See our ferro alloy business is very small business. We have a capacity of 12,000 tons per year. So that's a very small amount. So it's not going to have any impact when we reach 3.5 lakhs. So it's not of something which we need to discuss here and it's not something impactful thing here.

Chirag: Okay. Thank you.

Kirtan Mehta: Good afternoon, sir. Kirtan Mehta from Baroda BNP Asset Management. One follow-up question on the high grade versus low grade. In terms of the FY '27 production target of 25 lakh tons, what would be the breakup between high grade and low grade? And one more related question was, what's the difference in realization between high grade and low grade at this point of time? And between low grade when you sell in the domestic market versus export market, what's the difference in realization?

M.M. Abdullah: Generally, sir, the ore that is above 30% is considered as high grade and roughly 45% to 50% depending upon the area where we are mining, that will be high grade. And generally 15% to 20% will be the fines and the remaining is the low-grade ore in the total production.

Rashmi Singh: Yeah, as far as the realization is concerned, now you see there are various grades, we are making from 20% up to 46%. So there's a huge variation in prices. Like 20% will be let's say about maybe around INR2500 per ton and 46% will be about INR23,000, INR 24,000 per ton. So there's a huge variation.

Kirtan Mehta: Sure. One more question was about the semi-mechanization, mechanization that we are referring as well as change of mining method. So what kind of capex plan do we have for this year, next year? How much we have spent on this?

Rakesh Tumane: As far as capex plan is concerned, last year our capex we achieved was INR321 crores. This year our capex is around INR600 crores target is there. Again, this is MOU target, I explained what is MOU target. Of this INR325 crores we are trying to achieve in our mines itself, that is at the at the our the modernization of mines, the repairs and maintenance, that is the capex kind of repairment replacement, that kind of thing.

MOIL Limited

March 17, 2026

Page 15 of 22

And INR275 crores we have marked for the overseas acquisition. That makes the INR600 crores. So if we are looking out for the property abroad, and if we get some properties, then for that we have marked INR275 crores and INR325 crores for the domestic what is existing mines' capex.

Of this we are very confident that we'll be doing capex of INR325 crores.

See, this component of mechanization and then the changing mining method, see changing mining method would lead to more mechanization because at the moment when you have the long-hole open stoping, at the moment what happens in the cut and fill method when somebody goes into the mine, inside the mine ore body and they extract the ore. In long-hole open stoping method, you do not do that. It is all done by a remotely controlled LHDs. LHDs are Load Haul Dumpers.

Okay. So it's completely mechanization there when you have the long-hole open stoping. Manual intervention would be very, very minimal. So very high level of mechanization would be there.

So for that we have already drawn up our plan for with the existing method, we have drawn up a plan for mechanization

n, how many LHDs are required, how many drill machines are required, what kind of the transport system is required. That has already been taken care of.

And with this for our existing mines, our capex would be around say around INR350 crores, INR400 crores every year. And then we have seen that we are also coming with the four new five shafts, three production shafts are there and the two ventilation shafts are there. They would also be having some capex in the coming years.

So around INR400 crores we can say INR400 crores we can see that the capex would be required for the modernization of the existing mines. And for the next year our capex target is around INR800 crores, because INR400 crores around INR350 crores would be having for the modernization of our mines and the remaining would be for the overseas acquisition.

Kirtan Mehta: Thank you.

Digant Haria: My name is Digant Haria. Three questions, one for each of you, sir. So first Rakeshji, first question is for you that in 2027 we'll have this wage renegotiation and -- this whole thing. So we are at an employee cost of say INR550 crores ballpark for the last many years. Where does this number settle after the wage revision? And does it happen next year itself or it happens in financial year '28?

Rakesh Tumane: I'll answer that. See, wage revision is something which comes and we do. The wage revision for the officers would start from the 1st of January 2027, right? And for the workers, it would be from the August of 2027. But usually negotiations take place and then it usually goes to the next year. But once we have the and usually in officers' case also the report doesn't come on the 1st January 2027. It would be basically I'm not very sure even the wage revision committee is formed till now. It is not formed for the PSU officers it's not formed.

So when it will be coming, we do not know. Okay, only when the committee report is there, the government approves it, then only you start doing provisions for it. Okay. And for our workers, we have done a 10-year wage revision, so it is not going to happen this '27. We did it in 16, when will yours come?

MOIL Limited

March 17, 2026

Page 16 of 22

Management: 17 it happened in last?

Rakesh Tumane: 17 will come in. It will be coming in '27. But what is important is that the things that we are doing now, I just explained about the mechanization, the employee count going down, this would be beneficial, in fact, the impact of the wage negotiation wage revision would not be felt that much, because what is happening now we had a very static production, then after some time we took a very huge jump, around 35% of production increased.

Now again with the 35% increase, again the production jump would not be because the it would not go like this. It has to be some tapering has to be there because it was like this, we went like this, and something like tapering is happening now. But as these projects we talked about, the Balaghat project, Gumgaon projects, they come into high steam, then our mechanization, change of method, they are going to happen together.

Once that happens, then again it will be steep rise. In fact, you would see the rise in production would not be 38%, it will be much more than that. Once that happens, there will be steep rise in production. The employee count is going down, okay, so your the cost per ton would be even it would go down, in fact, it would be going down if it is not increasing.

Digant Haria: Sir, but last time there was a 20% increase in the employee cost overall because wage revision plus normal salary hikes. So this time also, whenever '28 or '29, we can expect that 20% kind of a hike from whatever?

Rakesh Tumane: Whatever number of hike we say, that is an absolute amount, right. That would be absolute amount on the wage cost itself, okay. But when you talk about the cost

per ton, that rise would

not be there. In fact you in fact, you would be having the 9 months' figure, okay. You look at the 9 month figure for the salary cost. It's not increasing much. It is around 2%-3%. No, it's same

for last three years actually. No, this 9 months, the increase in the employee cost was around only 2%. Not even 5%. In fact, we generally assume 5% is the what is called as the normal increase in the...

Digant Haria: No, no, sir. I'll tell you why I ask this is, before 2020, our other income used to be INR200 crores because we used to have INR2500 crores of cash. Now last 5 years, we have put five vertical shafts, we've done a lot of capex, but you know, somehow our other income has fallen because the cash levels have gone, but profits are still in that INR300 crores, INR 350 crores range. Like when do we break out to that INR500 crores range?

Rakesh Tumane: The other income has gone down, so you should be happy. All money has gone to...

Digant Haria: Sir, very happy, but when do the profits rise, that's the...

Rakesh Tumane: No, no. That money, which used to be a huge money of we used to be, I know it was around INR3000 crores of cash we were having, and now we are having around INR1000 crores. And all that money has gone to you basically, though all it has gone to the investors. We have given see, we said that it has in per year return on our equity is around 176%, because all the money we have MOIL has returned to investors around INR3500 crores in last 9 years.

MOIL Limited

March 17, 2026

Page 17 of 22

So all money has gone to the investors. Investors should be happy. There will be very few company who would have given this much of returns to their investors. Very few company would have given this much of investors. We can see the share price, which is going up and down, okay, so sometimes that happens, the market is very volatile, and our share price is being beaten very badly, okay. So that's all good, okay. But the amount of money that we have returned to the shareholders is enormous. We have given a very good return to our shareholders.

Digant Haria: Correct, sir. We want to see that INR500 crores in profit number also...

Rakesh Tumane: Definitely, it will come, definitely it will come. See, right. To categorically reply to your question, that's not far off, okay. That's not far off. That's definitely going to come and in fact, it will be much more than that.

Digant Haria: Right, sir. So second question is to Rashmi ma'am. Right now, see, I think the global prices have again shot up to very good levels, but I see that the price hikes that we have taken is, you know, I don't know if we are commensurate, but to me it just looks like we are still a little lower than the global levels. Is it because Raipur has very low demand even now? Because when we met in August in your AGM, Raipur was generally very slow. But from Jan we hear it has picked up a little bit. So just any idea you can give here.

Rashmi Singh: In fact, MOIL has to because as, you know, it was explained, 70% of country's demand is being met through imports. So our prices are in line with imported prices. In fact, we keep the prices higher by about 5% to 6%. Because as I explained earlier, Raipur customers if they import, then they will have to incur higher logistic cost. So we take similar increase, rather we take 2% more. Prices are always kept about 5% to 6% higher than the imported prices. So whatever movement is there in the index, that is captured in our prices. You can see anytime our prices will be -- if the increase is 5%, we will increase by 6% -7%. Because you are not looking at the grade -- you are not comparing apples -to-apples.

If you see the product mix, the average NSR if you look at, then obviously that is not correct, you know, because you have to look at the same grade, 37% or 44%. These are the two grades for which

indices are available. So if you compare with that, our prices will always increase slightly more than the international prices. Always, as a rule.

Digant Haria: And in the demand environment in Raipur, do you see it improving?

Rashmi Singh: Excellent. It's continuously growing. That is why earlier, you know, Central region was mostly using our material, but now they have to depend on imported ore also.

Digant Haria: Okay. So if more production comes, you will be able to sell it completely, right?

Rashmi Singh: Absolutely. As I said, out of 3 million ton market, we are catering to a -- we are supplying only about 1.4 of high grade as I said. So there's room to grow by another, double it rather. There's absolutely no problem of demand.

Digant Haria: Okay. Thank you. Last question is to you, sir. So, see, government keeps giving that 15% -20% higher targets. Government has a very simple formula. Mining, it is never easy to grow volumes

MOIL Limited

March 17, 2026

Page 18 of 22

at 15% -20% every year. But sir, realistically, from these two new projects, let's say we end this year at 20, these two new projects, how much can they really contribute? Like first year not more than 1 lakh ton or like what would be your assessment? And when does this three vertical shafts,

you know, the complete output when do we start seeing that? Like what is the scale -up route?

M.M. Abdul la: Actually, when a shaft commences, when the shaft is made and it is commenced, the production will grow slowly. Actually, we have to first approach the ore body, then some underground drivages are required. And as the time goes on, we are having more number of phases. Suppose in the first month we are having a single phase, by developing in the second month we may having three more phases. So like that, it will increase. And the maximum capacity -- to achieve the maximum capacity of both the shafts, it will take at least five years to get fully using the capacity of those new shafts.

Digant Haria: So realistically, 1 lakh to 2 lakh -- 1 lakh of production increase every year is possible, right, from like if we are 20 this year, next year 21, 22? Because the 25, I don't know, it is just, you know, the government gives all PSUs very high targets, but I don't know if that is practically possible.

Rakesh Tumane: See, the targets are given to achieve -- we are taking steps also. We are doing some mechanization and we are doing some beneficiation of low -grade ores. All these things will contribute to it, right.

Digant Haria: And then Rakeshji, last thing you said cost of production is 5,500 a ton. That would only not include the royalties, employee cost, the mining cost?

Rakesh Tumane: It's a factory gate. So the cost of production is basically what's there in the cost accounting. So it's the cost of production of the factory gate.

Digant Haria: But then it should include the royalty as well, right?

Rakesh Tumane: Royalty would not be there. It's only the cost of production.

Digant Haria: Okay. Thank you.

Questioner : Hi, sir. I believe there is no question after that. So bit elaborative, if you can give the current production mine -wise, for example, Balaghat current production is 3.5, same for Ukwa, Tirodi, each mine, so that we can have a guess that how things are in each mine. And there is a follow - up which I'll say afterwards.

Rakesh Tumane: See, we have 10 mines.

Questioner : Right.

Rakesh Tumane: Okay. Seven are underground mines and three are opencast mines. See, usually in mining companies, for example, NMDC, they have only two, three mines. They will give the Donimalai, they will give what is that, Bailadila. They are only two, three mines. Hindustan Copper, two, three mines. So they can give that there. We have 10 mines, so giving the data individual of 10

MOIL Limited

March 17, 2016

Page 19 of 22

mines and you observing that, you analyzing that, it will create unnecessarily your time. So we would manage that, okay.

Questioner : Sir, I have lot of time, so if you can give...

Rakesh Tumane: We'll see that. Because it's not huge numbers. See, what happens there, our mines are smaller mines, for example, we do not do in millions. We do production in some lakhs, okay. So there is a difference. So giving the data about 10 mines and then you...

Questioner : It will take only two minutes in case you want to give. I have jotted the names. It will be good if you can give.

Rakesh Tumane: Okay, we'll see that. We'll see that.

Pallav: Yes, sir. Good afternoon, sir. This is Pallav from Antique. So first question was on, you know, what are the levels of manganese ore at Chinese ports? Have you seen them coming down? And also what are the reasons for the recent increase in manganese ore prices?

Rashmi Singh: Yes, good observation because the inventory at Chinese ports is also one of the major factors which determine the price movement. International prices are determined by inventory at Chinese ports. But the inventory has been coming down. Earlier, it used to be around 6 million ton. Currently it's about 4.3 million, 4.4 million ton, so inventory is low.

And as regards prices, see there are certain -- mainly it is the logistics which is a major factor for the prices to go up or down. Last year, you must be aware there was an incident at South32, Australian mine, Groote Eylandt, they had a major problem where the whole jetty was destroyed. And till date they have not been able to rebuild it. It's been almost more than a year now, one and a half years, and they are still working at it. So again, the supply disruption.

So mostly it is the supply disruption mainly due to logistics because mining is pretty okay. And there's another reason because there's huge amount of easy mining going on in South Africa. Mining is very easy. There is no underground mining anywhere of manganese other than MOIL and maybe one mine of South32 in Australia. These are the only two places where underground mining of manganese ore is taking place.

South Africa and Gabon, it's mostly opencast mining and easy mining. So these miners also control their output to keep the prices at a certain level. So if the demand -- suppose, you know,

Chinese demand is the main thing that basically determines the international demand. So if there is major movement from that part of the world, then all these miners, they try to regulate supplies and keep the prices higher.

Currently again because of logistics in South Africa, there was some problem with the Transnet allocation of railways, because of which there was delay in supply. And you must be aware after this recent geopolitical development, there has been a huge impact on logistics. So that's another reason why off late, if you have seen the prices in last two weeks, this Friday it was not so volatile, previous Friday prices shot up by almost 6%. So that was one of the major reason.

Mostly the reason is logistics.

MOIL Limited

March 17, 2026

Page 20 of 22

Pallav: So disruption actually if imports are affected, so probably MOIL can gain some market share. Is that a possibility? And also, you know, a question on the low grade, because you mentioned the realization is very low, you know, and our COP is higher. So is that another consideration for holding inventory that maybe even prices are better, that will be a good time to liquidate?

Rashmi Singh: Good question. Because we don't -- we continue to produce. There's no point in not producing lower grades. Because lower grades also get generated when you produce higher grades. So we like to not undersell that inventory or panic selling -- we don't resort to panic selling because we have seen that from our experience that prices, there is a huge volatility in manganese ore prices.

Mostly, for six, seven months they'll be stable and then there will be some incident because of which prices will move up. So we don't believe in panic selling. There is no dearth of space. We can hold stocks. We can beneficiate them when we want. So as I said earlier also that in terms of value, these inventories are not a very -- value is very little. So we don't sell under panic. We try to hold the inventory and try to sell at a reasonably good price.

One more question which I forgot to answer earlier, somebody had asked that what is the difference in realization between sales of these low-grade ores in domestic market and export market. We don't resort to selling at a low price in exports. Our ex-mine price for domestic sales as well as exports is same. So we don't we're not selling cheap in international markets.

Pallav: Sure. Lastly, just want to know, I think in the past when prices move up, probably even the low-grade material is acceptable to improve. So we've seen, like, almost two-three consecutive price hikes now, so that should really help your sales volume as well. Is that a possibility?

Rashmi Singh: No, volume as I said is not a challenge for MOIL, whatever we produce gets sold. For the sales of low grade, as I said, we wait for the right opportune moment and try to realize a good price.

And whenever we increase or decrease prices, we do so for all grades. For low grades also we increase prices when we increase prices for higher grades.

Pallav: Sure, thank you so much. Just one question. So in FY '27 and FY '30, how much will be your production will be coming from underground and Opencast mines? And what is the difference in cost of mining between these two?

M.M. Abdulla: We can take 70% from around -- 70% from underground mines and 30% from Opencast mines. And as far as cost of production is concerned, generally -- definitely underground mining is more costlier than the Opencast mining.

Pallav: But how much is the difference? And this opencast mine, how much more they can continue to produce from Opencast and when they will be converted to underground?

Rakesh Tumane: This -- exact figure of the Opencast and the underground, I'll not be able to tell just right now, but we can share when we are discussing. Okay. But definitely it is around 80% or 70% of the total what INR5500 I'm telling, so it would be around INR4200 would be the cost of production in the Opencast mines.

MOIL Limited

March 17, 2026

Page 21 of 22

M.M. Abdulla: And conversion of these Opencast mines into underground mines, we are having our biggest opencast mine Dongri Buzurg, and we are going for new shafts and it will convert into underground by five years.

Pallav: So let's say in five years down the line, you'll be having completely underground mines or it will be still Opencast?

M.M. Abdulla: No, no. We are having two more Opencast mines: one is Tirodi mine and one is Sitapatore mine. And Tirodi mine and Sitapatore mine, they are having pocket deposits. So as you explore, you generally find some pockets of ore and the mining is continuing there in the similar fashion.

Pallav: Okay, thank you.

Moderator: Any more questions?

Rakesh Tumane: Okay. So can I summarize a little bit? So basically, we have come here to meet all of you and talk about our company. We are seeing a very volatile market scenario. The whole geopolitics is very volatile and we do not know what is going to happen in terms of the energy prices, inflation, cost of living. That's all a very big question mark there.

So and that is getting reflected in the stock prices, and that is also getting reflected in the stock prices of MOIL Limited. But our basic intention of coming here was to talk to you, to assure you that our production plan, our future plans are in place. And it is a huge market.

First thing is that, the manganese market

in India is huge. The requirement of the manganese in

India is around 10 million tons of requirement is there. Out of this, almost 6.5 million tons is coming from imports, 3.5 million tons is being produced domestically, and out of 3.5 million tons, half is produced -- more than half is produced by MOIL. So there's a huge market there.

So MOIL is basically limited by how much we can produce. The more we produce, the more we'll be able to sell. The demand is there. So there's no demand constraint there. That's one important thing. And to meet those demand issues, we have already working. We are completely in a process of completely changing our mining situation I would call.

Earlier our mining was mechanized, then we are making it semi-mechanized and we want to go to now fully mechanized mines. Then we want to change our mining method. At the moment, we are doing cut and fill method, which is a slow method, which is a very labor-intensive method.

We want to go to mechanized long hole open stoping method, which would be very productive method. We want to do that. And to support all these that we have drawn our capex plan. And we have to increase our future production capacity. We are bringing in new shafts.

At Dongri Buzurg, we are going from Opencast to the underground mining. Then at Kandri mine, we are putting another new shaft. Chikla mine, we are putting the third shaft there. So we are working on all aspects which a mining company should work on, which is a modernization, mechanization, automation, digitalization.

MOIL Limited

March 17, 2026

Page 22 of 22

Then for the low grades, we are already working on the beneficiation of the low grades. Then to use a low grades, we want to use make the briquettes so that the low grades can be utilized in a better form somewhere else. And we are also working on exporting our lower grades and we are also working on getting the overseas assets.

So whatever are the fills or whatever are the areas which a mining company should look at, we are working on that and we are committed to that. We are seeing all Director Production is here, Director Finance is here, Director Commercial is here. CMD could not come because there were some meetings in the ministry, so he could not join in.

But we are all committed to what we have promised, and MOIL is basically something is going to work to the expectations of the investors. And we have done that, and we have proved that we have said that around 176% return had been there for the last nine years on MOIL's equity.

So we are a good company to invest in, and we will be delivering what we are promising. So that's what I wanted to come here and tell you. We wanted to assuage any kind of doubts you have. We had so many questions in detail, so many questions were there about grades, about the pricing, about the NSR.

It was very nice to know that all of you are so much invested in MOIL and so much detail analysis you have. That's always nice to know, and in fact, if any other questions are there, they can send their queries and replies and we can answer in a common mode. Okay, then. Thank you very much. It had been a great -- I think Parthiv is there to conclude the ceremony.

Anand Rathi: Thank you, everyone. We will now conclude the Investor and Analyst Day. We would again like to thank the management for giving Anand Rathi the opportunity to host the event today we would request all the participants to please proceed for lunch along with the management. Thank you so much, have a good day

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